

CLAT Express - December 2025: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Aravalli Range: Facts and Rulings

The Aravalli range is one of the oldest mountain systems in India. It runs through Gujarat, Rajasthan and Haryana, and reaches Delhi. The range acts as a natural barrier that slows the spread of the Thar Desert, because it blocks dust-laden desert winds. It also influences the southwest monsoon by guiding moisture-laden winds towards the Indo-Gangetic Plains. In winter, its hills shield the northern plains from cold, dry winds. Its forested stretches help clean the air of the National Capital Region by absorbing carbon dioxide and trapping fine particles. Its forests are also home to many plant and animal species. Rocks in the range allow rainwater to seep into the ground, which supports groundwater in semi-arid areas. The area also supports mining-based livelihoods and industries. Because of these uses, the range has faced pressure from mining and urban growth for many years. Courts and government bodies have therefore introduced several measures to limit mining and restore forests. In 2025, the Supreme Court accepted a uniform scientific definition of an Aravalli hill, based on an expert committee's advice. The definition determines which landforms receive protection, and it has raised concern that mining and construction could expand into areas left outside it. Understanding both the ecology and the legal steps helps explain why the range is in the news.

Q1.

Which peak is the highest in the Aravalli range, and in which state is it located?

- (A) Mount Abu, Haryana
- (B) Champaner, Gujarat
- (C) Raisina Hill, Delhi
- (D) Guru Shikhar, Rajasthan

Q2.

Approximately how old is the Aravalli mountain system, the oldest in India?

- (A) About 2 billion years
- (B) About 500 million years
- (C) About 1 billion years
- (D) About 3 billion years

Q3.

What is the total length of the Aravalli range from Gujarat to Delhi?

- (A) 500 km
- (B) 800 km
- (C) 1000 km
- (D) 692 km

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Aravalli range is a source of valuable minerals such as copper and zinc.

Reason (R): The range is a source of the Luni and Banas rivers.

In the context of the above two statements, which of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Champaner	A. Highest peak of the range
II. Raisina Hill	B. Originates in the range
III. Guru Shikhar	C. End point of the range in Delhi
IV. Luni river	D. Starting point of the range in Gujarat

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Supreme Court's 2025 ruling on the Aravalli range:

- I. Any landform rising 100 m or more above its immediate local terrain is an Aravalli hill.
- II. Clusters of such hills within 500 m, including intervening areas, form an Aravalli range.
- III. Mining is permitted in core or inviolate areas such as protected areas and wetlands.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Aravalli range are correct?

- I. The range extends 692 km from Gujarat to Delhi.
- II. Guru Shikhar, the highest peak, lies in Haryana.
- III. The Aravalli Green Wall Project was launched in 2019.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Key features check

Rural employment policy has been under review since the government introduced the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Bill, 2025 in the Lok Sabha. The proposal would replace MGNREGA, which critics say has grown outdated as rural livelihoods and employment patterns have changed. Concerns have also been raised that the older scheme created assets of low utility or limited durability. The government presents the new law as part of its national vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

The funding model is also changing. The earlier scheme relied on open-ended funding that was largely borne by the Centre. The new bill moves to a model of shared financial responsibility between the Centre and the States, with different ratios for different regions. Supporters argue that predictable allocations make budgeting easier and help the Centre target spending.

Planning is meant to begin in villages. Gram panchayats prepare their own plans, which are linked to infrastructure programmes and then combined at the national level. Panchayats are also to be graded on development indicators. Oversight will come from councils at the Centre and in the States, along with steering committees that advise on allocations and coordination between

ministries.

Farmers have long reported labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons, and the bill gives States a tool to respond. Overall, the government says the reform will strengthen rural income security while improving transparency and accountability.

Q1.

What is the statutory guarantee of unskilled manual work per rural household per financial year under the proposed bill?

- (A) 180 days
- (B) 100 days
- (C) 150 days
- (D) 125 days

Q2.

Assertion (A): State governments can suspend the scheme for up to 60 days during sowing and harvesting seasons.

Reason (R): The suspension is meant to ensure availability of agricultural labour during these seasons.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack	A. Skilling, toolkits and credit linkage for artisans
II. PM Gati Shakti	B. Aggregates Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans for national planning
III. SVAMITVA	C. Infrastructure convergence with village plans
IV. PM Vishwakarma	D. Property cards to rural households

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the VB-G RAM G Bill:

- I. Panchayats that underperform on development indicators may receive higher allocations.
- II. Works must align with five national priorities for durable asset creation.
- III. Wages are envisaged to be paid weekly, instead of within a 15-day cycle.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about MGNREGA and the proposed bill are correct?

- I. MGNREGA was enacted in 2005.
- II. For most states, the Centre-State funding ratio under the bill is 60:40.
- III. Under MGNREGA, the central government bears 100% of the cost of unskilled labour wages.
- IV. The bill envisages paying wages within 15 days of completion of work.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

What share of funding is borne by the Centre for North-Eastern and Himalayan States under the bill?

- (A) 100%
- (B) 75%
- (C) 60%
- (D) 90%

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT one of the four national priorities for durable asset creation under the bill?

- (A) Water Security
- (B) Core Rural Infrastructure
- (C) Livelihood-related Infrastructure
- (D) Digital Banking Infrastructure

Q8.

Within how many days of a household's application must work be provided, failing which an unemployment allowance is payable?

- (A) 15 days
- (B) 7 days
- (C) 10 days
- (D) 30 days

Lok Adalat basics

Lok Adalat, whose name means 'People's Court', is a forum based on Gandhian principles that offers an expeditious and cost-effective alternative to dispute resolution through the courts. It works as a forum where cases that are pending in a court can be taken up, and disputes that are still at the pre-litigation stage can be brought before it as well. The aim is to have these matters compromised or settled in an amicable manner. A Lok Adalat organised for an area consists of serving or retired judicial officers and other persons of that area, as specified by the agency that organises it. In general, the panel has a judicial officer as Chairman, with a lawyer and a social worker as Members. Lok Adalats have been given statutory status by law, which places them firmly within India's legal framework. Every award made by a Lok Adalat is final and binding on all parties to the dispute. The organising authority for Lok Adalats is the National Legal Services Authority. Because the process rests on agreement between the parties, it saves time and money compared with a long trial. The panel's role is to help the parties arrive at a common outcome. The mechanism is therefore a key part of India's alternative dispute resolution system.

Q1.

In which year was the first Lok Adalat in India organised?

- (A) 1982
- (B) 1987
- (C) 1995
- (D) 2002

Q2.

Under which Act do Lok Adalats have statutory status?

- (A) Indian Penal Code, 1860
- (B) Civil Procedure Code, 1908
- (C) Constitution of India, Article 21
- (D) Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987

Q3.

Assertion (A): Every award made by a Lok Adalat is final and binding on all parties to the dispute.

Reason (R): Lok Adalats can settle offences that are non-compoundable under any law.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Permanent Lok Adalat	A. Chief Justice of the State High Court as Patron-in-Chief
II. National Lok Adalat	B. Chief Justice of India as Patron-in-Chief
III. NALSA	C. Disputes on public utility services
IV. High Court Legal Services Committee	D. Held across India on a single day

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Judicial Data Grid was developed by the National Informatics Centre.
- II. SUVAS is a machine-assisted translation tool trained by artificial intelligence.
- III. SUPACE is a portal that secures electronic transmission of interim orders.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Permanent Lok Adalats:

- I. They were made possible by a 2002 amendment to the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987.
- II. They have jurisdiction over any offence, including offences not punishable by law.
- III. Their judgments are final and binding on all parties involved.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Which Supreme Court case held that a Lok Adalat is purely conciliatory?

- (A) Swapnil Tripathi v. Supreme Court of India (2018)
- (B) Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973)
- (C) Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978)
- (D) State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh (2008)

Q8.

What does FASTER stand for in the Supreme Court context?

- (A) Fast and Secured Transmission of Electronic Records
- (B) Fast Access System for Tribunal Electronic Records
- (C) Fully Automated Secure Transmission of Evidence
- (D) Fast Automated System for Recording

Assam Bill: practice MCQs

Polygamy is a marital system in which a person has more than one spouse at the same time. Its prevalence in India is measured through national family surveys, which ask married women about their husbands' marital arrangements and compare results across religions and states. Such data helps lawmakers judge whether a practice needs stronger legal action. In 2025 the Assam Assembly passed a Prohibition of Polygamy Bill, described as introducing strict penalties to curb polygamous practices. Its stated objective is to eliminate such practices in the state. The Bill applies to residents of Assam. It addresses marriages that were formed before the law came into force, and it includes provisions for women who were affected by polygamous marriages. Existing Indian law already treats the issue in different ways. Some statutes prohibit bigamy for certain communities, while the personal laws of other communities allow multiple marriages within limits. The Bill therefore sits at the meeting point of criminal law, family law and personal laws, and its design reflects the need to balance social reform with the rights of communities and individuals. Any such law must also be read alongside Fundamental Rights, because a marriage that violates them can be legally challenged under some personal laws. Debates on the subject often return to the same question, namely how far a single legal framework can respect the diversity of religious communities across the country.

Q1.

Which state has the highest rate of polygamy in India according to NFHS-5 (2019-21)?

- (A) Meghalaya
- (B) Assam
- (C) West Bengal
- (D) Tripura

Q2.

What does the Grandfather Clause in the Bill ensure?

- (A) Invalidates previous polygamous marriages
- (B) Exempts all elderly citizens
- (C) Protects patriarchal systems
- (D) Validates pre-law marriages compliant with personal or customary laws

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maximum imprisonment for a second marriage while the first is valid	A. NFHS-5 (2019-21)
II. Source of national polygamy data	B. Section 82
III. Offence of marrying again during a spouse's lifetime	C. Article 342
IV. Article excluding Scheduled Tribes	D. 10 years

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025:

- I. The Bill covers individuals engaged in polygamous marriages outside Assam.
- II. The Bill applies to those availing benefits from Assam's welfare schemes.
- III. The Bill bars convicted individuals only from government jobs and schemes.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Bill are correct?

- I. Entering a second marriage while the first is legally valid attracts imprisonment under the Bill.
- II. Village heads and qazis can be held accountable for facilitating polygamous marriages.
- III. Convicted persons may contest elections after serving their sentence.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

What fund does the Bill introduce for women affected by polygamous marriages?

- (A) Legal Aid Fund
- (B) Rehabilitation Fund
- (C) Housing Fund
- (D) State Victim Relief Fund

Q7.

Which legal framework does the Bill aim to strengthen?

- (A) Family law ensuring monogamous marriages
- (B) Criminal law
- (C) Property law
- (D) Constitutional law

Why the rupee weakened in 2025

The Indian rupee depreciated by over 5% in 2025 and, by December, had crossed 90 per US dollar. The fall was not the result of one sudden shock. Analysts instead pointed to a mix of global and domestic pressures that had been building over time. Strength in the US dollar was a major backdrop, and the rupee was also hit by delays in a trade arrangement between India and the United States that investors had been anticipating. Money flowed out of Indian markets as global risk sentiment shifted. On the domestic side, the gap between what India buys from abroad and what it sells drew close attention. Crude oil prices rose, and some exports to major destinations were under strain. Demand for dollars also grew in the currency market as businesses and traders responded to the expectation of further weakness in the rupee. The 90 level drew particular attention from traders, who treat such round-number thresholds as important. Market participants said the fall had built up over time rather than arriving in a single day. Experts said the rupee's path in the months ahead would depend on global financial conditions, external trade developments and domestic economic indicators.

Q1.

Which set of imports did the booklet identify as widening India's trade deficit in 2025?

- (A) Only agricultural products
- (B) Only textiles
- (C) Only services
- (D) Gold, electronics, crude and machinery

Q2.

Which group of investors does the booklet say withdrew funds aggressively, adding to capital outflows?

- (A) Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)
- (B) Domestic mutual funds
- (C) Non-Resident Indians
- (D) The Reserve Bank of India

Q3.

What is the maximum US tariff on Indian exports cited in the booklet's account of 2025 rupee pressure?

- (A) 25%
- (B) 35%
- (C) 60%
- (D) 50%

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. FPI withdrawals	A. Concerns over tariffs and export access
II. Higher crude oil prices	B. Speculative dollar demand
III. Importers front-loading dollar purchases	C. Worsened import bill
IV. Delays in the initial tranche of the India-US trade deal	D. Capital outflow from India

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the rupee's weakness in 2025:

- I. Foreign Portfolio Investors withdrew funds aggressively from India.
- II. India was seen as a liquidity source amid global risk rebalancing.
- III. Higher crude oil prices reduced India's import bill.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Global uncertainty shifted capital to US Treasuries and the US dollar as safe havens.
- II. Speculative dollar demand came mainly from exporters selling dollars early.
- III. Lower investor confidence reduced inflows into India.
- IV. The United States imposed tariffs of up to 25 per cent on Indian exports.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

By how much did the Indian rupee depreciate in 2025, according to the booklet?

- (A) Over 3%
- (B) Over 7%
- (C) Over 10%
- (D) Over 5%

Repo Cut and Goldilocks: MCQ Practice

In December 2025, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) cut the policy repo rate to 5.25 per cent. The move was intended to sustain what the RBI called a Goldilocks phase, a balanced condition that is neither too hot nor too cold. In such a phase, the economy grows strongly while inflation stays low. Monetary policy works through the repo rate in both directions. When inflation rises, the central bank can make borrowing costly, which curbs excessive spending and slows investment. When the economy needs more money, the central bank lowers the rate, so that loans become cheaper for banks, which then pass lower interest rates on to borrowers and businesses. The December cut was

justified on three grounds. Inflation had fallen sharply below the lower end of the target range, which created room for easing without risking price instability. Growth also remained robust despite global uncertainties. Finally, global trade headwinds and other external pressures made a pre-emptive stimulus useful in offsetting a slowing expansion. Lower rates are expected to boost lending, consumption and investment. They may, however, weaken the rupee and reduce returns on fixed deposits, which could discourage household savings. The rate decision itself is taken by a statutory body called the Monetary Policy Committee, which works within India's flexible inflation-targeting framework.

Q1.

How many of the following statements about the Monetary Policy Committee are correct?

- I. The MPC is required to meet at least four times in a year.
- II. The quorum for an MPC meeting is five members.
- III. The RBI Governor has a casting vote in case of a tie.
- IV. MPC decisions are taken by unanimous vote.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q2.

By how many basis points did the RBI cut the repo rate in December 2025?

- (A) 25 basis points
- (B) 75 basis points
- (C) 50 basis points
- (D) 100 basis points

Q3.

What was India's inflation rate in October 2025, as cited in the booklet?

- (A) 1.7%
- (B) 2.0%
- (C) 4.0%
- (D) 0.3%

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the repo and related rates.

- I. The repo rate is the rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks.
- II. The reverse repo rate is the rate at which RBI borrows money from commercial banks.
- III. The Bank Rate is a short-term rate at which RBI lends money to other banks.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

What was the total reduction in the repo rate by the RBI during 2025, in basis points?

- (A) 100 basis points
- (B) 150 basis points
- (C) 175 basis points
- (D) 125 basis points

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Repo Rate	A. Long-term rate at which central bank lends to other banks
II. Bank Rate	B. Share of deposits banks must hold as cash with RBI
III. Cash Reserve Ratio	C. Window for banks to borrow overnight funds at higher rate than repo
IV. Marginal Standing Facility	D. Rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Summit economics and payments

India and Russia used their 23rd Annual Summit in New Delhi to widen cooperation well beyond their traditional areas. The summit came after the two countries upgraded their ties to a special and privileged strategic partnership, and it marked 25 years of that relationship. The leaders adopted a comprehensive programme meant to diversify bilateral ties beyond defence and energy. Its work is coordinated by a commission that handles trade, economic, scientific, technical and cultural cooperation between the two governments, and that body serves as the apex forum for economic dialogue between them.

Trade and finance formed a central part of the discussions. Both sides agreed to boost settlements in national currencies, and they decided to work on interoperability of their payment systems and digital currencies. Officials described this as a way to reduce reliance on Western financial channels. The leaders also reaffirmed their commitment to energy security, with continued support for nuclear power projects in India, including small modular reactors and future civil nuclear work.

The summit also addressed terrorism. Both countries called for strict action against all UN-listed terrorist organisations and endorsed a zero-tolerance approach grounded in international law. Connectivity and mobility were additional priorities, as the two governments pursued new routes for cargo and skilled professionals.

Q1.

Which Indian minister chairs the IRIGC-TEC, the commission that coordinates Programme 2030?

- (A) External Affairs Minister of India
- (B) Prime Minister of India
- (C) Finance Minister of India
- (D) Commerce and Industry Minister of India

Q2.

What trade target has been set for India and Russia under Programme 2030 (in US dollars)?

- (A) \$100 billion
- (B) \$68.7 billion
- (C) \$50 billion
- (D) \$120 billion

Q3.

Payment-system cooperation under the summit seeks to bypass which Western-led financial messaging system?

- (A) NEFT
- (B) RTGS
- (C) UPI
- (D) SWIFT

Q4.

Assertion (A): Russia formally joined the International Big Cat Alliance during the summit.

Reason (R): India welcomed Russia's interest in joining the International Solar Alliance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Programme 2030	A. \$100 billion by 2030
II. Payment-system interoperability	B. Built in India with Russian cooperation
III. Trade target by 2030	C. Diversify ties beyond defence and energy
IV. Kudankulam Nuclear Power Plant	D. Bypass SWIFT

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the outcomes of the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. Negotiations on a free trade agreement with the Eurasian Economic Union are to be fast-tracked.
- II. The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok sea route passes through the Malacca Strait.
- III. The 2030 trade target of \$100 billion has already been reached.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit are correct?

- I. Putin's visit to India was his first in four years, since 2021.
- II. Russia formally joined the International Solar Alliance during the summit.
- III. Both sides denounced the Pahalgam attack (2025) and the Crocus City Hall attack (2024).
- IV. The trade target under Programme 2030 is \$68.7 billion.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor aims to reduce the time taken to transport cargo to Russia by what percentage?

- (A) 40 per cent
- (B) 30 per cent
- (C) 25 per cent
- (D) 50 per cent

The Durand Line Border

The Durand Line is a long international boundary that separates Pakistan from Afghanistan. Its origins lie in the colonial period, when British India and Afghanistan were locked in a long and often violent relationship. Britain fought several wars with Afghanistan, and some of these conflicts ended in settlements that changed how Afghanistan's external relations were handled. The boundary itself was fixed through a late nineteenth-century arrangement that involved British officials and the Afghan ruler of the time. Its path crosses demanding terrain, from mountain ranges in the north to deserts further south. When British rule over the subcontinent ended, the boundary passed to Pakistan, while Afghanistan has continued to question its legitimacy. Many communities that live near the line share ethnic and cultural ties across it, so the boundary affects families and tribes as well as governments. Tensions along the frontier have periodically resurfaced, and recent allegations of airstrikes near the line have drawn fresh attention to a dispute that began more than a century ago. Students preparing for current affairs should understand both the historical background and the modern implications of this boundary, since disputes of this kind shape regional security and diplomacy. Diplomatic exchanges about the border have often focused on whether the boundary is legitimate, and these debates continue to shape relations between the neighbouring states.

Q1.

Which 1893 agreement fixed the Durand Line?

- (A) Treaty of Gandamak
- (B) Treaty of Lahore
- (C) Treaty of Rawalpindi
- (D) Durand Agreement

Q2.

Which treaty ended the 1919 Anglo-Afghan War?

- (A) Treaty of Gandamak
- (B) Durand Agreement
- (C) Simla Agreement
- (D) Treaty of Rawalpindi

Q3.

The Wakhan Corridor was created as part of the Durand Line arrangement for what purpose?

- (A) A strategic buffer separating British and Russian spheres
- (B) A trade route linking Kabul and Delhi
- (C) A pilgrimage route for Pashtun tribes
- (D) A river boundary with Iran

Q4.

In which year did the Durand Line pass to Pakistan?

- (A) 1893
- (B) 1919
- (C) 1947
- (D) 1961

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anglo-Afghan War (1839-42)	A. Restored Afghanistan's foreign policy autonomy
II. Treaty of Gandamak (1879)	B. British intervention failed
III. Treaty of Rawalpindi (1919)	C. Drew the Durand Line
IV. Durand Agreement (1893)	D. Britain gained control over Afghanistan's foreign affairs

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Durand Line:

- I. The Durand Line passes through the Karakoram Mountain Range.
- II. Pakistan inherited the Durand Line after Partition in 1947.
- III. Afghanistan formally recognised the Durand Line soon after 1947.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Courts, Waqf and Competition Law

Indian courts have long held a power to punish persons who disrespect them, and recent developments have brought this power back into focus. In a recent ruling, the Supreme Court stated that the power to punish for criminal contempt is not a personal shield for judges. The Court also stressed that judges have the authority to forgive an offender, and that forgiveness can be given alongside punishment. Contempt is generally divided into two broad categories, and each category protects the justice system in a different way. Separately, the government has moved to bring Waqf property records into a single digital system. A minister recently made an announcement about the registration of Waqf properties. The system, known as UMEED, is meant to make the management of Waqf properties more efficient and transparent. Meanwhile, the Competition Commission of India has started to examine a sudden disruption to airline services. The regulator is checking whether a dominant company has misused its market position, which is a matter covered by competition law. Such steps show how courts, regulators and ministries each shape the rules that citizens and companies must follow in everyday life. Each institution in these stories works within a defined legal framework, which is why the exact provisions matter.

Q1.

Which provision makes the Supreme Court a Court of Record with power to punish for contempt of itself?

- (A) Article 215, for the High Courts
- (B) Article 129, for the High Courts
- (C) Article 215, for the Supreme Court
- (D) Article 129, for the Supreme Court

Q2.

Which Act governs contempt proceedings in India?

- (A) Waqf Act, 1995
- (B) Energy Conservation Act, 2001
- (C) Competition Act, 2002
- (D) Contempt of Courts Act, 1971

Q3.

Read the two statements and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Criminal contempt includes acts that scandalise or lower the authority of a court.

Reason (R): Criminal contempt covers wilful disobedience of a court's judgment or order.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 129	A. High Courts
II. Article 215	B. Competition Act, 2002
III. Competition Commission of India	C. Waqf Act, 1995
IV. UMEED portal	D. Supreme Court

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Criminal contempt covers acts that scandalise or lower the authority of a court.
- II. Civil contempt covers wilful breach of an undertaking given to a court.
- III. The Competition Commission of India was established in 2002.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The CCI consists of a Chairperson and 2 to 6 Members.
- II. The Ministry of Corporate Affairs is the nodal agency for UMEED.
- III. Civil contempt includes wilful disobedience of a court's judgment.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

The CCI has taken cognisance of flight disruptions of which airline to probe a possible abuse of dominant position?

- (A) Air India
- (B) SpiceJet
- (C) Akasa Air
- (D) IndiGo

Ecological Services of the Range: MCQ

The Aravalli range performs a set of ecological services that reach well beyond its own slopes. Its landforms affect how air moves across north-western and northern India, and this in turn influences the climate of areas far from the hills. The range interacts with the winds of the year, acting on the monsoon during the summer rains and on the cold winds that reach the plains in winter. Its land also has a role in the water cycle, because rain that falls on the range can move into the ground. The forested stretches of the range are relevant to the National Capital Region, where they contribute to the quality of the air. The hills are home to a wide variety of living things, and plants, birds and animals find habitat across the range. The surrounding landscape also includes wildlife sanctuaries and bird parks, reflecting this biological richness. The range is also a source of several important rivers, which links its ecology to water supplies across the region. The range stretches across Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi, so these effects are felt across several states. Taken together, these functions connect the hills to the climate, water, air and biodiversity of the plains beside them. The hills also host a variety of birds and other animals, which adds to their biological importance across the region.

Q1.

The Aravalli range is described as a natural barrier against the eastward spread of which desert?

- (A) Thar Desert
- (B) Sahara Desert
- (C) Kalahari Desert
- (D) Gobi Desert

Q2.

Approximately how many plant species does the Aravalli range provide habitat for?

- (A) Over 100
- (B) Over 500
- (C) Over 1,000
- (D) Over 300

Q3.

From which region do the cold, dry winter winds that the range shields the northern plains from originate?

- (A) Central Asia
- (B) South-East Asia
- (C) Western Ghats
- (D) Arabian Peninsula

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Aravalli range helps recharge groundwater in semi-arid parts of Rajasthan, Haryana and Gujarat.

Reason (R): Its highly fractured and weathered rocks allow rainwater to infiltrate.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Green lungs of Delhi-NCR	A. Protects northern plains from cold, dry winter winds
II. Monsoon modulator	B. Recharges aquifers in semi-arid regions
III. Winter climate shield	C. Deflects moisture-laden winds eastward toward the Indo-Gangetic Plains
IV. Groundwater recharge zone	D. Traps PM2.5 and improves air quality

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Aravalli range:

- I. The range blocks dust-laden desert winds.
- II. Its highly fractured rocks prevent rainwater from entering the ground.
- III. The range has no effect on the Southwest Monsoon.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I only

Mining Curbs and the 2025 Ruling: MCQ

Protection of the Aravalli range has developed through a series of measures over several decades. Mining has been a central concern, since the range has long supported extraction activity and related livelihoods. The range is a source of minerals such as copper, zinc, lead and silver. Restrictions on that activity began in the 1990s, and the Supreme Court has issued several orders over the years. These orders have altered what is permitted in the hills, including a 2024 order. A proposed conservation plan has also been put forward to guide the range's future. In 2025 the Court accepted a single scientific definition for what counts as an Aravalli hill, drawing on work by an expert panel. The definition matters because it determines which landforms fall under the protections that apply to the range. The range stretches across Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi, and the protective measures apply across that wider area. Several states share this landscape, so the rules made for the hills affect a broad region. The range is also home to wildlife sanctuaries, tiger reserves and bird parks, which gives it biological importance alongside its economic value. The Forest Survey of India has also assessed the range, and its findings have fed into the wider discussion over which hills should be counted. The range is a fold mountain system formed by orogenic activity, so its geology is also long in the making.

Q1.

In which year did the Supreme Court impose a blanket mining ban in parts of Haryana?

- (A) 2004
- (B) 2014
- (C) 2009
- (D) 2019

Q2.

A 2024 Supreme Court order gave which body a scientific review role?

- (A) National Green Tribunal
- (B) Central Pollution Control Board
- (C) Central Empowered Committee
- (D) Forest Survey of India

Q3.

Which ministry's expert committee provided the basis for the Supreme Court's 2025 uniform definition of an Aravalli hill?

- (A) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- (B) Ministry of Mines
- (C) Ministry of Jal Shakti
- (D) Ministry of Tribal Affairs

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. MC Mehta vs Union of India	A. Strict regulation preferred over blanket bans
II. Calibrated approach	B. Foothills, valleys and recharge zones left unprotected
III. Risks of degradation	C. Supreme Court restricted and banned mining across large parts of the range
IV. Ecological continuity ignored	D. Groundwater depletion, desertification and dust storms

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Aravalli range:

- I. The Proposed Aravalli Conservation Plan calls for no-mining zones.
- II. The 2025 definition sets the height threshold for an Aravalli hill at 50 m.
- III. Mining is banned across all Aravalli areas under the 2025 ruling.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the statements below are correct?

- I. The Proposed Aravalli Conservation Plan calls for ecological restoration measures.
 - II. The 2024 order barred fresh mining leases.
 - III. The Court has said blanket bans are preferable to calibrated regulation.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Case for Replacing MGNREGA

The Viksit Bharat G RAM G Bill 2025 was brought forward to replace MGNREGA, the rural employment law that has shaped rural work for many years. The government has circulated the bill to members of Parliament. It describes the bill as a framework for rural development aligned with a national vision, and says the bill aims to boost rural employment, promote durable asset creation and align development with infrastructure-led growth.

The government's case for change rests on the argument that the older framework is now outdated. It points to major transformations in the rural economy, in livelihoods and in employment patterns since the earlier law was enacted. These shifts, the government says, make the older design a poor fit for present conditions. Critics have also questioned the quality of the assets created under the scheme.

The bill also changes how the programme is funded. Under the earlier model, funding was open-ended and mostly drawn from one level of government. The new framework uses a shared arrangement, and normative allocations are expected to improve fiscal management and targeted spending.

Labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons form part of the rural context behind the change. The bill also adds a digital layer to oversight, with a planned digital ecosystem meant to reduce leakages, improve transparency and track work effectively.

Q1.

Criticism of MGNREGA concerned the creation of which kind of assets?

- (A) Durable and high-utility assets
- (B) Rural housing assets
- (C) Low-utility or non-durable assets
- (D) Urban infrastructure assets

Q2.

How is the Viksit Bharat G RAM G Bill's scheme classified?

- (A) Centrally Sponsored Scheme
- (B) State-funded scheme
- (C) Fully central-funded scheme
- (D) Private-public partnership

Q3.

Which group reports labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons?

- (A) Urban employers
- (B) Forest officials
- (C) Traders
- (D) Farmers

Q4.

Assertion (A): The bill is framed under the national vision of Viksit Bharat @2047.

Reason (R): The bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha to replace MGNREGA.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Digital technologies under the bill	A. Prepared by Gram Panchayats
II. Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans	B. Recommendations on financial allocation
III. Central and State Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Councils	C. Biometric authentication
IV. National and State Steering Committees	D. Review, monitor and advise

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the bill:

- I. Under the bill, the grading of panchayats is based on development indicators.
- II. Higher allocations are given to underperforming panchayats to reduce regional disparities.
- III. Panchayats are graded on the basis of their population size.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

MGNREGA and the Proposed Bill

The Viksit Bharat G RAM G Bill 2025 proposes a new rural employment framework in place of MGNREGA. The booklet compares the two frameworks on six features: guaranteed workdays, wage funding, nature of the right, budgeting approach, operating period and payment frequency.

On guaranteed workdays, the proposed bill raises the statutory guarantee for each rural household. On wage funding, the earlier model placed most of the cost on one level of government, while the new bill introduces a shared arrangement for most states.

The two frameworks also differ in how the guarantee is framed and in how work is planned. Under the earlier scheme, planning followed the demand for work reported by states. The proposed bill, by contrast, sets an allocation in advance for each state and allows work to be paused in busy agricultural periods. The booklet also notes that the proposed bill mandates a digital ecosystem to reduce leakages.

Payment timing also differs. The earlier law set a deadline for paying wages after work was completed, and the new bill sets out a different pattern aimed at improving the cash flow of workers. Overall, the booklet presents the proposed bill as an upgrade that fixes structural weaknesses while enhancing employment, transparency, planning and accountability.

Q1.

Under MGNREGA, what share of the unskilled labour wage cost did the Centre bear?

- (A) 60%
- (B) 90%
- (C) 100%
- (D) 75%

Q2.

What term does the booklet use for the nature of the proposed bill's entitlement?

- (A) Schematic entitlement
- (B) Justiciable right
- (C) Open-ended funding
- (D) Labour budget

Q3.

Under the proposed bill, who determines the fixed state-wise annual funding allocation?

- (A) State governments
- (B) Gram Panchayats
- (C) District collectors
- (D) The Centre

Q4.

Assertion (A): The proposed bill's statutory guarantee is limited by a fixed budget cap.

Reason (R): The proposed bill envisages paying wages weekly to improve workers' cash flow.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Budgeting approach under MGNREGA	A. Continuous operation without seasonal pauses
II. Operating period under MGNREGA	B. Justiciable right
III. Nature of right under MGNREGA	C. Fixed state-wise annual allocation
IV. Budgeting approach under the proposed bill	D. Labour budget reflecting actual demand for work

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the two frameworks:

I. Under MGNREGA, the Centre bore the full cost of unskilled wages.

II. The proposed bill describes the entitlement as a justiciable right that citizens can enforce in court.

III. The proposed bill envisages paying wages weekly.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the two frameworks are correct?

Under MGNREGA, funding was based on a labour budget reflecting actual demand for work.

The proposed bill's statutory guarantee is limited by a fixed budget cap.

Under MGNREGA, the operating period was designed to be continuous.

Under the proposed bill, citizens can sue the government if work is denied.

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only one
- (D) All of the above

NALSA and legal aid structure

Legal aid in India is delivered through a network of institutions rather than a single office. At the top of this network sits the National Legal Services Authority, which guides a chain of bodies that reach down to the districts and to the courts. The network exists so that people who cannot easily afford a lawyer are not shut out of the justice system, and its services are meant to be offered on the basis of equal opportunity. The institutions are also expected to spread awareness about legal rights, so that people know when and how to seek help. They organise Lok Adalats and promote the settlement of disputes outside a formal trial. The national body is further expected to monitor how legal aid programmes are working and to develop the rules that govern them. The law that created this network also set out principles on which legal services are to be provided, and these principles guide every level of the structure. Before the present structure was built, the government had already recognised the need to supervise legal aid schemes at the national level, and a dedicated committee was created for that purpose. Each level of the network has its own authority or committee, and together they are meant to make legal help available to people from every background, whatever their income or social position.

Q1.

Who is the Patron-in-Chief of NALSA at the national level?

- (A) Union Minister of Law
- (B) Attorney General of India
- (C) Secretary, Ministry of Law
- (D) Chief Justice of India

Q2.

Assertion (A): The Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 was enforced on 9 November 1995.

Reason (R): The Act was enacted by Parliament.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987	A. Headed by the Chief Justice of the State High Court
II. High Court Legal Services Committee	B. Constituted under the Act
III. District Legal Services Authority	C. Statutory base for legal aid programmes
IV. National Legal Services Authority	D. Ex-officio chairman is the District Judge

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B

Q4.

Article 39A of the Constitution provides for which of the following?

- (A) Right to speedy trial
- (B) Right to form associations
- (C) Right to privacy
- (D) Free legal aid to poor and weaker sections

Q5.

Consider the following statements about NALSA and legal aid:

- I. Objectives of legal services institutions include providing compensation to victims of crime.
- II. The Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 was enacted by State Legislatures.
- III. A State Legal Services Authority operates at the state level.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Which committee was set up at the national level in 1980 to supervise legal aid programmes?

- (A) CILAS
- (B) NALSA
- (C) SUPACE
- (D) Ministry of Law and Justice

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the legal aid network:

- I. Legal aid institutions operate at taluka or sub-division level.
- II. The Supreme Court has its own Legal Services Committee.
- III. The Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 came into force on 1 January 1987.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

e-Courts Project and digital tools

The e-Courts Project is an effort to bring information and communication technology into courts across India. It was based on a plan prepared for the judiciary to change its working through digital

tools, and its work has moved through several phases over more than a decade. The phases have extended computerisation to district and subordinate courts, and the project now includes platforms for managing case records. Digital platforms carry case information from courts at several levels. Other tools serve judges and litigants more directly. Some tools support language needs so that regional languages can take a larger role in court proceedings, while others securely transmit electronic records such as interim orders and bail orders to the authorities concerned. A separate tool supports judges in their work. Courts have also begun to stream some of their hearings live. The project is funded by the central government ministry that deals with law and justice matters. Each of these tools is part of the same effort, and together they show how technology has been brought into different parts of the court system. The phases were carried out one after another over the years, and the tools described here belong to that same programme of work. Each tool has a different purpose, from handling language needs to managing the flow of orders between courts and the authorities that act on them.

Q1.

Which body developed the National Judicial Data Grid?

- (A) Supreme Court of India
- (B) National Legal Services Authority
- (C) National Informatics Centre
- (D) Ministry of Law and Justice

Q2.

What is the main function of SUPACE?

- (A) Securely transmitting interim and bail orders to concerned authorities
- (B) Translating judgments into regional languages using machine translation
- (C) Collecting relevant facts and laws and making them available to a judge
- (D) Live-streaming court proceedings on a YouTube channel

Q3.

Which phase of the e-Courts Project was implemented during 2007-2015?

- (A) Phase I
- (B) Phase II
- (C) Phase III
- (D) Phase IV

Q4.

Assertion (A): Live streaming of court proceedings is protected as part of the right to access justice.

Reason (R): The Supreme Court held in *Swapnil Tripathi v Supreme Court of India* (2018) that live streaming is part of the right under Article 21.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. SUVAS	A. ICT enablement of courts
II. SUPACE	B. Online database of orders, judgments and case details
III. National Judicial Data Grid	C. Machine-assisted translation tool trained by AI
IV. e-Courts Project	D. Collects relevant facts and laws for judges

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the e-Courts Project:

- I. The Gujarat High Court was the first court to live-stream judicial proceedings on its YouTube channel.
- II. The e-Courts Project is funded by the National Informatics Centre.
- III. Phase III of the e-Courts Project spans four years from 2023 onwards.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Polygamy rates and types

Polygamy is the subject of a new law in Assam, where the state assembly has passed the Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025 to introduce strict penalties against such practices. The topic sits within the wider field of marriage and family law in India, where personal laws for different communities treat marriage in different ways. The prevalence of polygamy is measured through a national health survey, which reports figures for the country as a whole, for individual states and for religious communities. Assam's figure is set against the national average, and the state's religious communities are reported separately. The survey covers currently married women in a particular age band and records whether their husband has other wives besides themselves. Such figures allow comparison between states and between religious groups across the country. The Bill is framed as an effort to eliminate polygamous practices, and its provisions extend to residents of Assam as well as to certain people who engage in polygamous marriages outside the state. Its scope therefore reaches beyond marriages performed inside the state. The statistics form the background to the legislative debate in the state, and they are cited alongside the provisions of the Bill. Readers who follow the topic will also see how the law interacts with the marriage statutes that operate across the country.

Q1.

What is the NFHS-5 (2019-21) polygamy rate reported for Assam?

- (A) 1.4 per cent
- (B) 3.6 per cent
- (C) 2.4 per cent
- (D) 6.1 per cent

Q2.

According to the same survey, which religious group in Assam records the higher rate?

- (A) Hindus
- (B) Both identical
- (C) Neither is reported
- (D) Muslims

Q3.

Which term describes a system in which one woman has several husbands?

- (A) Polygyny
- (B) Bigamy
- (C) Polyandry
- (D) Monogamy

Q4.

Assertion (A): Assam's polygamy rate is above the national average.

Reason (R): The national rate for Christians is above that for Muslims.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The national rate for Others is higher than the national rate for Muslims.
- II. Sikhs record a higher national rate than Hindus.
- III. Assam's rate is higher than Meghalaya's.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I only

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Polyandry means one man has several wives.
- II. Hindus have a national polygamy rate of 1.3 per cent.
- III. The national rate for Christians is 1.3 per cent.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Personal laws and marriage

Marriage in India is governed by personal laws that differ according to religion, so the legal position on a second marriage is not the same for every community. Statutes differ on whether a second marriage during the subsistence of the first is treated as wrongful, while other personal laws leave room for more than one spouse. The legal framework is part of the background to the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025, which the state assembly has passed. Criminal law also addresses marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse, under a code enacted in 2023. The Bill applies to residents of Assam and also covers individuals engaged in polygamous marriages outside the state, which gives it a reach beyond the state's own population. The Uniform Civil Code is the idea of a common set of personal laws that would apply to all citizens irrespective of religious affiliations. Several judgments of the Supreme Court have discussed the need for reform of personal laws over the decades. The Law Commission has also examined the subject in its

consultation report. The Bill's objective is to eliminate polygamous practices across India, not only in Assam. The debate on uniformity has continued for many decades. Each of these points forms part of the wider context in which the state's Bill is discussed.

Q1.

Which Act permits polygamy among Muslims in India?

- (A) Hindu Marriage Act, 1955
- (B) Special Marriage Act, 1954
- (C) Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, 1937
- (D) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023

Q2.

In which year was the Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act enacted?

- (A) 1954
- (B) 1955
- (C) 2023
- (D) 1937

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, 1937 prohibits polygamy.

Reason (R): Polygamy is permitted under the Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, 1937.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

I. Bigamy is prohibited for Hindus under the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955.

II. The Shariat Act, 1937 prohibits polygamy among Muslims.

III. Marriages under the Shariat Act that violate Fundamental Rights can be legally challenged.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) II and III only

Q5.

What can be done with Shariat marriages that violate Fundamental Rights?

- (A) Legally challenged
- (B) Automatically annulled
- (C) Exempted from review
- (D) Registered again

Q6.

Under the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, what is a second marriage contracted while the first subsists?

- (A) A civil wrong only
- (B) A punishable offence
- (C) Permitted with court consent
- (D) Valid if registered

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Hindu Marriage Act, 1955 prohibits bigamy for Hindus.
 - II. The Special Marriage Act, 1954 permits polygamy.
 - III. A second marriage during the subsistence of the first is a punishable offence under the Hindu Marriage Act.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only three
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

The 90 Per Dollar Breach

The Indian rupee crossed the 90 per US dollar mark in 2025, a development that marked a notable moment in the currency's recent trajectory. Over the course of the year, the rupee had weakened against the dollar, and the slide carried it below that level. India's financial markets experienced heightened volatility as a result. The fall came even as the economy showed strong growth and inflation stayed low, which nonetheless raised concerns about the country's broader macroeconomic stability. Market analysts attributed the rupee's weakness to a combination of global and domestic factors. Investors had been watching several developments closely through the year. The 90 level was noticed widely across markets, and the move past it drew attention from participants in the currency market. The breach was reported as part of the December 2025 current affairs coverage of the economy. As the currency continues to navigate these headwinds, policymakers and investors alike will be closely monitoring global financial conditions, external trade developments and domestic economic indicators to assess the rupee's stability in the months ahead. Coverage of the episode has drawn attention to the currency's movement across the year and to the mix of developments that shaped it. The breach has been discussed as a moment worth tracking in the months that follow.

Q1.

What GDP growth rate did the booklet cite for India at the time of the rupee's fall?

- (A) 8.2%
- (B) 7.5%
- (C) 9.0%
- (D) 6.8%

Q2.

What kind of importance does the booklet attribute to the 90 level for traders?

- (A) Legal importance
- (B) Fiscal importance
- (C) Tax importance
- (D) Psychological importance

Q3.

According to the booklet, what does the 2025 breach of 90 per dollar reflect?

- (A) A single disruptive event
- (B) A deliberate devaluation by the RBI
- (C) Cumulative pressures built over time
- (D) A sudden surge in exports

Q4.

When the rupee crosses 90 per US dollar, which type of orders can be activated?

- (A) Buy-stop orders
- (B) Sell-stop orders
- (C) Limit orders
- (D) Forward contracts

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the 2025 rupee breach are correct?

- I. Market analysts cited sustained strength in the US dollar as a factor behind the weakness.
- II. The breach is described as having been caused by a single disruptive event.
- III. Strong growth and low inflation were reported at the time.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Assertion (A): Crossing the 90 level can intensify downward momentum in the rupee.

Reason (R): Crossing 90 can activate buy-stop orders.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is false but R is true
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the rupee's weakness in 2025:

- I. Delays in the initial tranche of the India-US trade agreement were among the factors behind the weakness.
- II. Investors had been anticipating the initial tranche of the India-US trade agreement.
- III. Crossing 90 per dollar reduces the chance of buy-stop orders being activated.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Depreciation or Devaluation

When a currency's value falls, financial news commonly uses two terms: depreciation and devaluation. Both describe a lower value for the currency against foreign currencies, yet the terms are not identical, and the distinction matters when a currency's movement is discussed. In recent months, the rupee's decline against the US dollar has been described mainly in terms of depreciation. Analysts have pointed to the sustained strength of the dollar as one of the wider developments in the background, alongside uncertainty about trade ties between India and the United States. Understanding the two terms helps readers follow economic debates. A fall in a currency's value can be discussed in different ways, depending on what is being described. The rupee's movement in 2025 was reported in the December 2025 current affairs coverage of the economy, and the booklet explains the vocabulary used in that coverage. Readers of current affairs should therefore look at the context in which a currency's value changes before deciding which term applies. The terms appear often in news coverage of the rupee, which makes them useful to recognise when reading about the economy. The rupee's decline is one example of how these terms are used in practice. Both terms are used in the booklet's economy section, which explains each one in turn.

Q1.

Under which exchange rate system does devaluation occur?

- (A) Floating exchange rate
- (B) Free market system
- (C) Managed-floating system
- (D) Fixed or pegged exchange rate

Q2.

Which of the following does the booklet list as a cause of rupee depreciation?

- (A) Current account deficit
- (B) Devaluation by the RBI
- (C) Fixed peg adjustments
- (D) Government export subsidies

Q3.

Assertion (A): Devaluation is carried out as a policy tool rather than through market forces.

Reason (R): Devaluation happens when the government or RBI deliberately reduces the currency's value.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

What does the booklet say devaluation is used for, as a policy tool?

- (A) Attracting foreign portfolio inflows
- (B) Increasing dollar-denominated debt
- (C) Boosting exports and reducing the deficit
- (D) Raising import tariffs on gold

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Depreciation	A. Where depreciation happens
II. Devaluation	B. Where devaluation happens
III. Fixed or pegged system	C. Caused by market forces, capital flows and external shocks
IV. Floating system	D. Deliberate reduction by the government or RBI

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Depreciation can be caused by a rise in inflation and a larger current account deficit.
- II. Devaluation happens under a floating exchange rate system.
- III. Devaluation is a market-driven fall in the currency's value.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the rupee are correct?

- I. Depreciation happens under floating or managed-floating systems.
- II. Devaluation can be caused by global shocks.
- III. Depreciation can be triggered by policy uncertainty.

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Effects of a Weaker Rupee

A currency's fall against foreign currencies has effects that run in more than one direction through an economy. Some effects are favourable, while others add costs to households, businesses and the government. The booklet presents these consequences under two headings, positive and negative, which helps readers weigh gains against burdens. Trade, government budgets and companies are all touched by such changes, and the effects can be felt in different ways by different groups. In 2025 the rupee's weakness drew close attention in financial markets, even though India's economy showed strong growth at the time. The booklet also discusses measures aimed at stabilising the rupee. The booklet's account therefore covers both sides of the picture, so readers can see how each consequence is grouped under its heading and how the two headings relate to one another in the economy section. Under the positive heading, the booklet lists effects that make some parts of the economy more competitive. Under the negative heading, it lists effects that raise costs for households, businesses and the government. The booklet also explains the reasons behind several of these effects, so each one can be understood in context rather than in isolation. The rupee's path in 2025 is one example of how such effects appear in practice, since its weakness was discussed alongside India's growth.

Q1.

What does a weaker rupee make costlier for companies that hold dollar-denominated loans?

- (A) Only their tax bills
- (B) Their equity capital
- (C) Their cash reserves
- (D) Repayment and interest costs

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Higher subsidy burden	A. Costlier essential imports
II. Boost to exports	B. Fertiliser imports become costlier
III. Capital flight risk	C. Indian goods become cheaper globally
IV. Lower consumer purchasing power	D. Weak rupee reduces investor confidence

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q3.

Which group gets a more favourable exchange rate when sending money home during rupee depreciation?

- (A) Importers of crude oil
- (B) NRIs
- (C) Fertiliser manufacturers
- (D) Government of India

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A weaker rupee makes Indian goods more expensive for foreign buyers.
- II. A weaker rupee can widen the current account deficit.
- III. A weaker rupee can raise imported inflation in crude oil and fertilisers.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. A weaker rupee lowers the subsidy bill on fertilisers.
- II. NRIs get a more favourable exchange rate on remittances.
- III. A weaker rupee encourages domestic manufacturing as imports become expensive.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only two

Q6.

Which of these is a negative impact of rupee depreciation?

- (A) Higher subsidy burden
- (B) Boost to exports
- (C) Higher value of remittances
- (D) Push to domestic manufacturing

Q7.

Assertion (A): A weaker rupee can encourage domestic manufacturing.

Reason (R): Expensive imports encourage local production.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is true but R is false

Repo Rate and Other Tools

Monetary policy is formed and managed by the central bank to control a nation's overall money supply and to achieve economic growth. It differs from fiscal policy, which is managed by the Ministry of Finance and measures spending and taxation in the economy. The Reserve Bank of India releases a Monetary Policy Report once every six months, explaining the sources of inflation and forecasting it for six to eighteen months ahead. The Monetary Policy Committee is chaired by the RBI Governor and determines the policy rate required to achieve the inflation target. The repo rate is the central tool in this framework. When inflation is high, the central bank raises it so that the flow of money in the economy slows down. Borrowing becomes expensive for businesses and industries, investment slows, and excessive spending is curbed. Changes in this rate pass through to the cost of credit across the economy, so lenders and borrowers both feel the effect. The central

bank also has other instruments at its disposal. Each of them acts on a different part of the banking system, and each is designed for a specific purpose. Together these tools let the central bank steer liquidity, price stability and growth in the economy, which is the broad aim of monetary policy.

Q1.

What does the 'Repo' in 'repo rate' stand for?

- (A) Reserve Pricing Offer
- (B) Regulated Payment Option
- (C) Repurchasing Option
- (D) Revised Purchase Obligation

Q2.

Which rate is the rate at which RBI borrows money from commercial banks?

- (A) Repo rate
- (B) Reverse repo rate
- (C) Bank Rate
- (D) Cash Reserve Ratio

Q3.

Which facility allows banks to borrow overnight funds at a rate higher than the repo rate?

- (A) Cash Reserve Ratio
- (B) Statutory Liquidity Ratio
- (C) Open market operations
- (D) Marginal Standing Facility

Q4.

Assertion (A): RBI lowers the repo rate when it needs to pump funds into the economy during a short-term liquidity crunch.

Reason (R): A lower repo rate makes loans cheaper for banks, which increases the overall supply of money in the economy.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A higher repo rate makes loans costlier for banks.
- II. Bank Rate is a short-term rate, while the repo rate is a long-term rate.
- III. The Marginal Standing Facility lets banks borrow overnight funds at a rate lower than the repo rate.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about monetary policy tools are correct?

- I. Open market operations are used to inject or absorb liquidity.
- II. Bank Rate is a long-term rate at which the central bank lends to other banks.
- III. The reverse repo rate is the rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Price Indices and Their Coverage

Prices in an economy do not all move together, so official statisticians rely on several indices to track them. Each index is built with its own scope and method. One widely used measure groups household spending into commodity groups such as food, fuel and light, clothing and footwear, housing, pan, tobacco and intoxicants, and miscellaneous items. The same kind of measure also appears in separate versions for agricultural labourers, rural labourers and industrial workers. Each commodity group carries a weight, expressed as a percentage, that determines how much it influences the final figure. A group with a higher weight therefore matters more to the index. The choice of index changes what a number means, so readers must check what each one covers before comparing figures. Some measures capture a broad range of spending, while others rely on a narrower set of items. Two sources that track the same period can therefore show different movements, even when both are official. Knowing what each series includes is the starting point for reading any published price figure. Index values are compared with a reference point, and the coverage of each measure determines which prices enter that comparison. Some measures are built on a narrow set of commodities, while others are compiled from a much wider set of items.

Q1.

Which year is the base year of the Consumer Price Index?

- (A) 2010
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2018

Q2.

Which body releases the Wholesale Price Index?

- (A) National Statistical Office
- (B) Reserve Bank of India
- (C) Office of Economic Advisor, Ministry of Commerce and Industry
- (D) Ministry of Finance

Q3.

Which index is described as reflecting up-to-date expenditure patterns?

- (A) WPI
- (B) GDP deflator
- (C) Consumer Food Price Index
- (D) CPI

Q4.

Assertion (A): WPI is a measure of wholesale prices.

Reason (R): WPI includes only goods and does not consider the services sector.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. CPI includes both goods and services.
- II. WPI is released by the National Statistical Office.
- III. Inflation is a fall in the overall prices of goods and services over time.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about price indices are correct?

- I. Inflation refers to an increase in the overall prices of goods and services in an economy over time.
- II. CPI is released by the Office of Economic Advisor.
- III. GDP deflator measures wholesale prices alone.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) All of the above
- (D) Only three

Origins and Functions of the RBI

The Reserve Bank of India is the institution that the country relies on for managing its financial system. Its role has grown over time, and it now touches the government, the banking sector and the wider public. The Bank sets policy and keeps watch over the institutions that carry it out. Among its responsibilities it holds and manages the foreign exchange reserves that the country maintains. The Bank was created after a period of official consideration, under a law passed when the country was under foreign rule. Its work is defined by statute, and that statute gives it powers over money and banking. Monetary policy, which the Bank manages, differs from fiscal policy handled by the Ministry of Finance, which deals with government spending and taxation. The Bank publishes a Monetary Policy Report once every six months to explain the sources of inflation. The RBI Governor is the ex-officio chairperson of the Monetary Policy Committee, which determines the policy rate needed to meet the inflation target. The Bank's influence on everyday finance is therefore broad, and its statute defines the scope of its authority. The Bank's presence is felt in everyday finance, through the notes people carry, the rates banks charge and the rules that govern the wider system.

Q1.

Which commission recommended the establishment of the Reserve Bank of India?

- (A) Chakravarty Committee
- (B) Hilton Young Commission
- (C) Urjit Patel Committee
- (D) Simon Commission

Q2.

Dr. Ambedkar's strategies, set out in his book on the rupee, inspired the concept of which institution?

- (A) The Monetary Policy Committee
- (B) The Finance Commission
- (C) The Reserve Bank of India
- (D) The Securities and Exchange Board of India

Q3.

On what date was the Reserve Bank of India established?

- (A) January 26
- (B) April 1
- (C) August 15
- (D) July 1

Q4.

Assertion (A): The RBI acts as banker to the Government of India.

Reason (R): The RBI manages all financial operations of the Central Government under the RBI Act of 1934.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The RBI is the custodian of the cash reserves of commercial banks.
- II. The RBI has been privately owned since its establishment.
- III. The RBI intervenes to stabilise USD/INR currency volatility.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the RBI are correct?

- I. The RBI can grant bank licences and inspect commercial banks.
- II. The RBI's concept was inspired by a book written by Mahatma Gandhi.
- III. The RBI regulates the forex market through exchange rules.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Corridors and Connectivity with Russia

India and Russia treat transport links as a practical part of their wider partnership. The 23rd Annual Summit, held in New Delhi, discussed several corridors that could make the movement of goods between the two countries easier. The most prominent proposal is the Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor, a sea route linking the Indian port of Chennai with the Russian port of Vladivostok. Its stated purpose is to carry cargo and reduce the time needed to reach Russia compared with the existing route between the two ports.

A second channel is the International North-South Transport Corridor, a transport network that includes India, Russia and other member states. Both corridors appear in the summit's connectivity agenda, which also covers Russia's Far East and the Arctic.

Cooperation in the Far East and the Arctic is guided by a separate programme, which lists several sectors for joint work. These sectors include mining, pharmaceuticals and manpower. The summit also addressed trade more generally, with a comprehensive programme meant to diversify ties beyond defence and energy.

The partnership itself has a long history. India and Russia have a treaty of peace and friendship, and in 2010 their relationship was upgraded to a Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership. Transport planning sits alongside these political agreements, and the summit documents list connectivity among its major outcomes.

Q1.

Which of the following is listed among the key areas of India-Russia Far East and Arctic cooperation?

- (A) Textiles and footwear
- (B) Diamonds and shipping
- (C) Nuclear reactors and satellites
- (D) Tea and coffee

Q2.

Which three countries set up the International North-South Transport Corridor in 2000?

- (A) Russia, China and India
- (B) Iran, Turkey and India
- (C) Iran, Russia and India
- (D) Iran, Russia and Japan

Q3.

Through which of the following water bodies does the proposed Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor pass?

- (A) Suez Canal
- (B) Bosphorus Strait
- (C) Panama Canal
- (D) Malacca Strait

Q4.

Assertion (A): The International North-South Transport Corridor was set up to promote transportation cooperation among its member states.

Reason (R): The INSTC is a multi-modal transportation route.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Northern Sea Route	A. India is an Observer
II. Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor	B. Arctic shipping
III. Arctic Council	C. Covers 2024-2029
IV. India-Russia Far East Cooperation Programme	D. Proposed sea route

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the connectivity measures discussed at the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok corridor is expected to save up to 16 days of transport time.
- II. The International North-South Transport Corridor was established in 2000.
- III. India is a full member of the Arctic Council.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the connectivity corridors discussed at the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. The proposed Chennai-Vladivostok route passes through the South China Sea.
- II. The International North-South Transport Corridor was established in St Petersburg.
- III. The India-Russia Far East Cooperation Programme covers the period 2010-2020.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Diplomacy, Honours and Dialogue

India and Russia have a long diplomatic history, and the 23rd Annual Summit in New Delhi showed how both governments view the partnership. The meeting marked 25 years of strategic partnership, and its outcomes covered economic, defence, energy and migration topics. The summit also marked Russia's President's first visit to India in four years.

Security was another focus of the discussions. Both sides condemned attacks that had taken place in their countries. The two governments also discussed their cooperation in international forums such as the UN, G20, BRICS and SCO.

Honours also featured in the summit's record. Russia's highest national award was conferred on Prime Minister Narendra Modi for his contribution to fostering India-Russia ties. The award was presented during the visit, and it recognised the work done to strengthen bilateral relations.

Dialogue between the two countries also takes other forms. A platform for enhancing the Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership, which was upgraded in 2010, involves government bodies and research institutions. The summit documents describe cooperation in areas such as nuclear energy and defence, and they mention regular defence exercises as well. The defence agenda also includes joint research and development, co-production under Make in India, and military technology transfer.

Q1.

Which Tsar established the Order of St Andrew the Apostle in 1698?

- (A) Tsar Peter the Great
- (B) Tsar Nicholas II
- (C) Tsar Alexander I
- (D) Tsar Ivan III

Q2.

Which event is linked to the abolition of the Order of St Andrew the Apostle in 1918?

- (A) Crimean War
- (B) Russian Revolution
- (C) Second World War
- (D) Congress of Vienna

Q3.

Which ministry organised the Ganga-Volga Dialogue in collaboration with a research foundation?

- (A) Ministry of Defence
- (B) Ministry of Finance
- (C) Ministry of External Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Culture

Q4.

Assertion (A): Russia supports India's permanent membership of a reformed and expanded UN Security Council.

Reason (R): Both parties called for strict action against all UN-listed terrorist organisations.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Order of St Andrew the Apostle	A. Denounced by both parties
II. Ganga-Volga Dialogue	B. Double-headed eagle
III. Emblem of the Order of St Andrew	C. Conceptualised during the 2018 summit
IV. Pahalgam attack (2025)	D. Reinstated in 1998

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the outcomes linked to the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. The Treaty of Peace and Friendship between India and Russia was signed in 1971.
- II. The Ganga-Volga Dialogue is organised by the Ministry of Defence.
- III. Both parties called for a Zero-Tolerance Policy grounded in international law.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the honours and dialogues linked to the 23rd India-Russia Annual Summit:

- I. The Ganga-Volga Dialogue was conceptualised during the 2018 India-Russia summit.
- II. The Order of St Andrew the Apostle features a double-headed eagle emblem.
- III. The Order of St Andrew the Apostle was reinstated in 1918.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Karbi Anglong and Workplace Rights

Unrest in Karbi Anglong, the largest district of Assam, has renewed debate on land and resource rights. The current instability began with a hunger strike by indigenous tribal groups, who demanded the eviction of long-settled non-tribal communities. Protesters argue that these settlements in protected grazing and tribal lands are unconstitutional and illegal. The district is administered by an autonomous council that works under a constitutional scheme giving autonomy to tribal areas in the North-East. A tripartite peace accord signed in 2021 aimed to end decades of insurgency and promised the council greater legislative, executive and administrative powers.

Workplace rights are also under debate. A private member's bill introduced in the Lok Sabha seeks to give employees a statutory right to refuse work calls, emails or messages beyond working hours and on holidays. Such bills are introduced by MPs who are not ministers, and their passage is uncommon. Constant digital availability is linked to anxiety, sleep-related disorders and burnout.

Harassment complaints form another part of this debate. A Supreme Court judgment held that a woman can approach the Internal Complaints Committee at her own workplace when the harasser is an outsider. The ruling expands the jurisdiction of the law on sexual harassment at work, which is based on guidelines issued by the Supreme Court. Its aim is to prevent, prohibit and redress harassment, and it applies to all women irrespective of employment status.

Q1.

Under which article does the booklet say Parliament can create an 'Autonomous State' within Assam for certain tribal areas?

- (A) Article 366(25)
- (B) Article 39(e)
- (C) Article 244(A)
- (D) Article 342

Q2.

Which country's El Khomri Law (2017) was the first national law recognising the right to disconnect?

- (A) Australia
- (B) France
- (C) Japan
- (D) Germany

Q3.

In a workplace employing how many persons is an Internal Complaints Committee mandatory?

- (A) 5 or more
- (B) 20 or more
- (C) 10 or more
- (D) 50 or more

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Universal Declaration of Human Rights	A. Formed in 2006 to replace the UN Human Rights Commission
II. Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights	B. Criteria for effective national human rights institutions
III. UN Human Rights Council	C. Not a legally binding treaty but forms the International Bill of Human Rights
IV. Paris Principles	D. Established by the Vienna Declaration in 1993

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. An Internal Complaints Committee is mandatory in every workplace employing 10 or more persons.
- II. A Local Committee is constituted by the District Officer where an ICC is not available.
- III. The Right to Disconnect was first recognised as a national law in Australia in 2024.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights is a legally binding treaty.
 - II. Members of the Human Rights Council are elected for three-year terms.
 - III. The Human Rights Council was formed in 2006.
 - IV. Council members can be immediately re-elected after two consecutive terms.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) All of the above

Seismic Zones, Forests and Nuclear Bill

India has updated its seismic zonation map under the Earthquake Design Code of 2025, factoring in fault lines, tectonics and historical earthquake data. The revised map places the entire Himalayan arc in a new highest-risk zone for the first time. Towns located on the boundaries between zones will now automatically fall into the higher-risk category. The approach shifts focus from administrative boundaries to geological conditions, with stronger emphasis on active faults and the behaviour of rock and soil. This matters because a large part of the population lives in seismically active regions.

Forests face a growing threat from fire. According to the India State of Forest Report 2021, over 36 per cent of forests are prone to frequent fires. Governments have responded with schemes that support states in managing forest fires. At UNEA-7 in Nairobi, India's resolution on strengthening

global wildfire management was adopted.

Nuclear energy is also being reformed. A bill introduced in the Lok Sabha would open the sector to private companies and joint ventures with government entities. It would give the Atomic Energy Regulatory Board statutory status and create an advisory council to hear appeals against decisions of the Central Government and the regulator. Under the bill, the nuclear liability framework would move to a tiered structure based on reactor capacity.

Q1.

Before the revision, the Himalayan arc was split between which two seismic zones?

- (A) II and III
- (B) III and IV
- (C) IV and V
- (D) V and VI

Q2.

What percentage of India's population lives in seismically active regions?

- (A) 50 per cent
- (B) 61 per cent
- (C) 90 per cent
- (D) 75 per cent

Q3.

Which bill proposes to replace the Atomic Energy Act 1962?

- (A) Forest Fire Prevention Scheme
- (B) SHANTI Bill 2025
- (C) Mission Sampark
- (D) Earthquake Design Code

Q4.

Assertion (A): The International Big Cat Alliance was launched in 2023.

Reason (R): It was launched to celebrate 50 years of Project Tiger.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) A is true but R is false
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Pink Fire Retardant	A. Centrally sponsored scheme giving financial support to states
II. Bambi Bucket	B. Comprehensive plan to manage forest fires across India
III. National Action Plan on Forest Fires	C. Ammonium phosphate-based slurry designed to slow or suppress wildfires
IV. Forest Fire Prevention and Management Scheme	D. Special container hung under a helicopter and filled from a water source

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Center for Seismology operates the National Seismological Network.
- II. The SHANTI Bill 2025 would replace the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act 2010.
- III. Appendix II of CITES lists species threatened with extinction where commercial trade is prohibited.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The United Nations Environment Assembly was established in 2012.
- II. The International Big Cat Alliance aims to conserve seven big cat species.
- III. CITES Appendix I species are regulated through controlled trade.
- IV. CITES came into force on 1 July 1975.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Vande Mataram, HIV and Heritage

Parliament has scheduled a special discussion to commemorate 150 years of the national song, Vande Mataram. The song was composed as a patriotic response to the British promotion of a royal anthem. It was first published in a Bengali novel, and it later became the rallying cry of the Swadeshi movement after the Partition of Bengal. A decision of the Congress Working Committee in 1937 limited its national use to the first two stanzas, and that decision has been debated since. On 24 January 1950, the song was declared the national song, to be honoured equally with the national anthem.

Health policy is also part of this section. The National AIDS Control Programme aims at the prevention, control and management of HIV/AIDS in India. Its current phase is a central sector scheme that aligns with global development goals to end AIDS as a public health threat by a target year. Between 2010 and 2024, national HIV prevalence declined, and new infections fell sharply.

Heritage recognition also covers living traditions. Deepavali was added to UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list, which seeks to safeguard knowledge, practices and traditions passed across generations. The list has categories such as oral traditions, performing arts, social practices and traditional craftsmanship. Such recognition is intended to ensure that these traditions continue to be practised.

Q1.

Vande Mataram was first published in which 1882 Bengali novel?

- (A) Durgesh Nandini
- (B) Anandamath
- (C) Kapalkundala
- (D) Devi Chaudhurani

Q2.

Who declared Vande Mataram the national song on 24 January 1950?

- (A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (B) Dr B R Ambedkar
- (C) Sardar Patel
- (D) Dr Rajendra Prasad

Q3.

Unlike the national anthem, Vande Mataram is not enforceable under which Act?

- (A) Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act 1971
- (B) Official Secrets Act
- (C) Unlawful Activities Prevention Act
- (D) Flag Code of India

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Atal Bihari Vajpayee	A. Famous tune composed by Rabindranath Tagore
II. Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya	B. Commemorates Operation Vijay of 1961
III. Goa Liberation Day	C. Founder of Banaras Hindu University
IV. Vande Mataram	D. Pokhran-II nuclear tests

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The 1937 Congress decision allowed all stanzas of Vande Mataram to be used at national gatherings.
- II. Vande Mataram is enforceable under the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act 1971.
- III. Deepavali was inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list in 2025.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Atal Bihari Vajpayee was born on 25 December 1924.
 - II. Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya founded Banaras Hindu University.
 - III. Goa attained full statehood in 1961.
 - IV. India contributes about 5 per cent of the world's new HIV infections.
- (A) Only three
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only two
 - (D) All of the above

Fuel Norms, Reports and Defence Tests

Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency, or CAFE, norms are rules that set fuel efficiency standards for vehicles in India. The norms are designed to reduce fuel consumption, lower carbon dioxide emissions and curb air pollution. They apply to petrol, diesel, LPG, CNG, hybrid and electric passenger vehicles, and they are implemented in phases. Automobile manufacturers have pushed for relaxed emission standards compared with the CAFE-III norms.

Separately, the United Nations has released the seventh edition of its Global Environment Outlook, titled 'A Future We Choose'. The report states that the world is far off track from Paris Agreement targets. It also warns that pollution remains one of the largest environmental health risks, and that rapid land degradation threatens food security and biodiversity. The Outlook is described as a leading voice for planetary protection, and it defines the international environmental agenda.

In defence news, DRDO successfully tested the K-4 submarine-launched ballistic missile from INS Arighat. It also completed trials of the Akash-NG surface-to-air missile, which was produced in collaboration with Bharat Electronics Limited.

India also marks Antarctica Day on December 1, which commemorates the 1959 Antarctic Treaty. The treaty bans nuclear activities south of 60 degrees south latitude and preserves 10 per cent of Earth for peace and science.

Q1.

Under which Act are the CAFE norms notified?

- (A) Environment Protection Act, 1986
- (B) Energy Conservation Act, 2001
- (C) Motor Vehicles Act, 1988
- (D) Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981

Q2.

Which Ahom ruler established the Charaichung Royal Bird Sanctuary in 1633?

- (A) Rudra Singha
- (B) Gadadhar Singha
- (C) Siva Singha
- (D) Pratap Singha

Q3.

The Global Environment Outlook (GEO-7) is headquartered in which city?

- (A) Nairobi
- (B) Geneva
- (C) Paris
- (D) Manila

Q4.

Read the two statements.

Assertion (A): Phase I of the CAFE norms, in 2017-18, set baseline efficiency targets for passenger vehicles.

Reason (R): Phase II of the CAFE norms, in 2022-23, introduced stricter fuel efficiency targets.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Siliserh Lake	A. AST SpaceMobile (USA)
II. Kopra Reservoir	B. Rajasthan
III. Samudra Pratap	C. Chhattisgarh
IV. BlueBird Block-2	D. Indian Coast Guard

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Majuli is recognised as the world's largest river island.
- II. Phase III of the CAFE norms covers the years 2027-32.
- III. Phase I of the CAFE norms was implemented in 2022-23.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Pollution is linked to 9 million deaths every year.
- II. BlueBird Block-2 was placed into Low Earth Orbit by the LVM3-M6 launch.
- III. Samudra Pratap is India's first hydrogen fuel-cell passenger vessel.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Silicon Initiative, Solar Irrigation and Treaties

Pax Silica is a US-led strategic geo-economic and technology initiative. Its stated focus is building a secure, resilient and innovation-driven silicon supply chain. One of its key objectives is to reduce strategic dependencies on concentrated supply chains, while another is to strengthen technological leadership in semiconductors and AI.

SoLAR stands for Solar Irrigation for Agricultural Resilience. It aims to expand climate-resilient, solar-powered irrigation systems across South Asia and East Africa. The initiative seeks equitable and sustainable access for small and marginal farmers, and it promotes resilient agriculture under changing climate conditions.

On the 50th anniversary of the Biological Weapons Convention, India called for stronger global biosecurity, compliance and the promotion of peaceful uses of biological science. The convention is described as the first multilateral, legally binding disarmament treaty that eliminates an entire category of weapons of mass destruction. The convention is administered by the United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs.

The Asian Development Bank works to promote sustainable, inclusive and climate-resilient economic development in Asia and the Pacific.

UNESCO, the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, aims to foster shared humanity through education, science, culture and communication. UNESCO was established in 1945 and the organisation is headquartered in Paris, France. India has been re-elected to its Executive Board for 2025 to 2029.

Q1.

Which of the following countries is covered by SoLAR Phase II?

- (A) Nepal
- (B) Bangladesh
- (C) Sri Lanka
- (D) Bhutan

Q2.

Which convention, adopted in 1960, is described as the first legally binding international treaty devoted exclusively to the right to education?

- (A) Biological Weapons Convention
- (B) Antarctic Treaty
- (C) Kimberley Process Certification Scheme
- (D) UNESCO Convention against Discrimination in Education

Q3.

In the Kimberley Process, what term refers to rough diamonds used by rebel groups or their affiliates to finance armed conflicts against legitimate governments?

- (A) Conflict diamonds
- (B) Artisanal diamonds
- (C) Industrial diamonds
- (D) Synthetic diamonds

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Biological Weapons Convention (opened for signature)	A. 1966
II. Asian Development Bank (established)	B. 2019
III. India's chairmanship of the Kimberley Process (began)	C. 1972
IV. SoLAR Phase I (began)	D. 2026

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Biological Weapons Convention prohibits the acquisition and transfer of biological and toxin weapons.
- II. The Asian Development Bank is headquartered in Manila.
- III. The ADB revised India's FY26 GDP growth forecast down to 6.5 per cent.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Pax Silica's scope is limited to critical minerals and energy inputs.
- II. SoLAR Phase I was implemented by the International Water Management Institute and the Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation.
- III. The Kimberley Process is a tripartite mechanism involving national governments, the international diamond industry and civil society organisations.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Restoring the Green Cover

Restoring degraded land has become a central goal in the Aravalli region, where mining and urban growth have put pressure on the landscape for decades. Planners have drawn inspiration from a large African project that aims to hold back the spread of desert. The approach focuses on planting native species on degraded land to support ongoing afforestation. Nurseries are set up to grow saplings for continuing planting drives, so that seedlings are ready when they are needed. Damaged water bodies are also being restored. Invasive plant species are also removed. The work is coordinated centrally but depends on many partners, including non-governmental organisations, private companies and local communities. The National Forest Policy (1988) aims for at least one-third of total land area under forest or tree cover. The restoration is meant to control desertification, improve air quality and strengthen climate resilience in the Delhi-NCR region. Together, these measures aim to protect the region's green cover and water supply. The nurseries and planting drives span the states that the corridor crosses, including Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat and Delhi. Plantation work covers degraded land, and the approach relies on species that grow naturally in the region.

Q1.

What is the restoration target of the Aravalli Green Wall Project by 2027 (in million hectares)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Aravalli Green Wall Project launched?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Across how many districts does the Aravalli Green Wall Project cover (in number)?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which national mission, part of the National Action Plan on Climate Change, aims to restore degraded ecosystems and enhance forest cover? (name the mission)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which programme is a 750-acre urban forest being developed in the Aravalli region?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is India's Bonn Challenge target to restore degraded and deforested land by 2030 (in million hectares)?

Answer: _____

Planning and schemes check

Rural employment policy is being reshaped to match changes in the countryside. A legal guarantee of work has long been the base of the framework, but critics have pointed to scattered works and to assets that did not last. The proposed replacement treats planning as a village-level exercise. Gram panchayats prepare plans for their areas, and those plans are meant to be linked with larger infrastructure programmes so that core rural infrastructure, water and livelihood works are coordinated rather than separate. The local plans are then combined into a national picture, which the government says will support coordinated planning across the country.

Beyond wage work, the government runs several rural programmes. One helps self-help groups build self-employment and access finance. Another aims to build skills among rural youth. A further programme gives rural households records of their property, and another supports traditional artisans with skilling, toolkits and credit. Together, these measures are presented as part of a wider effort to promote livelihoods in villages.

The bill also seeks tighter monitoring. Officials plan to use digital tools, including biometric checks and data analytics, to reduce leakages and track work. Social audits are to be strengthened so that local communities can review how public money is spent.

Q1.

How many days of wage employment per rural household per financial year did MGNREGA guarantee? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What percentage share of funding does the Centre bear for States and UTs other than North-Eastern and Himalayan States under the bill? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under MGNREGA, within how many days of completion of work were wages to be paid? (in days)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which system aggregates the Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans for coordinated national planning? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans are integrated with which scheme for infrastructure convergence? (name of the scheme)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which scheme gives property cards to rural households? (give the acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year was MGNREGA enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Types of Lok Adalat

Lok Adalats take two main forms in the way they are organised. The National Lok Adalat is held at regular intervals across India on a single day, and in recent years it has also been held on a specific matter each month. The Permanent Lok Adalat is a different body, created to handle disputes involving public utility services such as transportation. Its chairperson is a District Judge or an Additional District Judge, or a person who is or has been a District Judge or has held a judicial office higher in rank. The chairperson sits with persons who have adequate experience in public utility services. A Permanent Lok Adalat has no jurisdiction over any situation involving an offence that is not punishable by law. Its judgments are final and binding on all parties involved. The Supreme Court has described a Lok Adalat as purely conciliatory, which means it works by helping the parties reach an agreement rather than by imposing a decision. Both forms aim to settle disputes quickly and at low cost, without the long process of litigation. Together, they show how the Lok Adalat system combines flexibility with binding outcomes, so that a settlement reached before the forum carries real legal weight.

Q1.

In which year was the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 amended to permit the setting up of Permanent Lok Adalats? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many other persons with adequate experience in public utility services sit with the chairperson of a Permanent Lok Adalat? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Apart from transportation, which public utility service is cited as an example of disputes handled by Permanent Lok Adalats?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which authority is the organising authority for Lok Adalats?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Supreme Court decide State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh, holding that Lok Adalat is purely conciliatory? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Since which year has the National Lok Adalat been held on a specific matter every month? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which state was the first Lok Adalat in India organised?

Answer: _____

UCC and courts: short answers

A Uniform Civil Code would mean one common set of personal laws that applies to all citizens, irrespective of their religious affiliation. The framers of the Constitution did not intend total uniformity in this area. The Central Government favours a common code, calling different matrimonial laws for various religions a threat to the nation's unity. The 2018 Law Commission report suggested reforming and codifying family laws across religions instead of pursuing a UCC at this stage. The Supreme Court has also referred to the matter in several judgments. In the Shah Bano case, the Court highlighted the need for uniformity in personal laws. Later rulings on talaq-e-biddat, also called triple talaq, dealt with a practice within personal law. The Court has also praised one Indian state that has a functioning UCC, calling it an example for others. The Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 also contains an offence for marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse, which is punishable with imprisonment and a fine. Personal laws continue to differ across religions in matters of marriage and property, and this difference is the core of the debate. Together these strands show how the UCC debate connects constitutional text, legislative reform and judicial rulings.

Q1.

Under which Article of the Constitution is the state's duty to implement a Uniform Civil Code placed? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Act of 1954 allows inter-religious marriages while explicitly prohibiting polygamy? (name of the Act)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Personal laws were placed in which list of the Constitution? (name the list)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian state did the Supreme Court hail as a 'shining example' of a functioning UCC? (name of the state)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which 2017 Supreme Court case held talaq-e-biddat (triple talaq) unconstitutional? (name of the case, first party)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which section of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 is marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse an offence? (number only)

Answer: _____

Ways to steady the rupee

When the rupee faces sustained pressure, policymakers can work on several fronts at once. One approach is to reduce how much India's trade depends on the dollar, so that more transactions with partner countries are settled in the domestic currency. A second approach is to make the rupee easier to trade and hold outside India, which would widen its use in global markets. Strengthening the external sector is another route, and this includes maintaining healthy foreign exchange reserves. The central bank can also step into the currency market, selling or buying dollars as conditions require, and it can adjust interest rates. Over the longer term, attention turns to structural matters. Improving export competitiveness, attracting foreign direct investment through better infrastructure and regulation, and making it easier to do business are all part of this picture. Gold imports also weigh on the external balance, so reducing them is part of the broader effort. Policy choices are also shaped by the need to control inflation. Taken together, these steps aim to ease pressure on the currency gradually, rather than resolving it in a single move.

Q1.

Which type of accounts does the booklet propose to expand to promote rupee-based trade settlement? (name in full)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which payment system's internationalisation does the booklet propose to boost global acceptance of the rupee? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which global body's SDR basket does the booklet say the rupee should work towards being eligible for? (short name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many numbered measures are listed under 'How Can Rupee Be Stabilised?' (in number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Apart from gold monetisation, which form of gold does the booklet name as a way to reduce gold imports? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Indian government securities does the booklet want included in global bond indices? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Along with Asia and the Gulf, which region's countries does the booklet name for local currency settlement agreements? (one word)

Answer: _____

MPC and Inflation Targeting: Typed Answer

India's monetary policy is framed within an inflation-targeting system. The Reserve Bank of India manages the money supply to achieve economic growth, which is different from fiscal policy handled by the Ministry of Finance. A statutory committee within the RBI decides the benchmark policy rate needed to keep inflation within a targeted range. The Central Government is empowered to constitute this committee, and its decisions are taken by majority vote. The Governor chairs it ex officio, and its decisions are binding on banks. India moved to flexible inflation targeting after an earlier expert panel formally set the target and its band. The inflation target is set by the government in consultation with the RBI. The RBI also releases a periodic report that explains the sources of inflation and its forecasts.

Q1.

How many members does the Monetary Policy Committee have? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the minimum number of times the MPC must meet in a year? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In the event of a tie in MPC voting, whose vote decides the outcome? (name the post)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which committee formalised inflation targeting in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the inflation target under India's framework? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year did India adopt flexible inflation targeting? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the tolerance band on either side of the inflation target? (in percentage points)

Answer: _____

Defence and logistics facts

Defence cooperation remains one of the strongest pillars of India's partnership with Russia. The two countries have agreed on a reciprocal logistics arrangement that allows their armed forces to draw mutual support while operating away from home bases. Under this arrangement, each side can access the other's military facilities, ports and airspace, and it provides simplified refuelling and maintenance for deployments.

A high-level dialogue that brings together the foreign and defence ministers of both countries helps align their strategic priorities. Russia has long been among India's largest suppliers of defence equipment, and the two sides continue to pursue joint research, co-production under Make in India and transfer of military technology. Regular joint exercises between the armed forces add to this cooperation, and recent frigates have been commissioned into the Indian Navy.

Several major platforms reflect this partnership. A cruise missile is being developed jointly by an Indian research organisation and a Russian design bureau, while Indian production lines build multi-role fighter aircraft and main battle tanks based on Russian designs. India has also procured

a long-range surface-to-air missile system from Russia, and a former Russian aircraft carrier has been refurbished for the Indian Navy.

Q1.

What percentage share of India's defence equipment supply did Russia account for? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did India and Russia sign a new Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation after the dissolution of the Soviet Union?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under what name was the former Russian aircraft carrier Admiral Gorshkov transferred to the Indian Navy after refurbishment?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which cruise missile was jointly developed by India's DRDO and Russia's NPO Mashinostroyeniya (NPOM)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Indian company produces the Sukhoi Su-30MKI multi-role fighter in India? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

By how many nautical miles does the proposed Chennai-Vladivostok sea route save distance over the existing route? (in nautical miles)

Answer: _____

Finance, Bonds and Cess

India's financial policy has recently moved on several fronts at once. The central bank has released a fresh national roadmap to widen financial inclusion over the coming years. It rests on the idea that access, gender sensitivity, livelihoods, financial education and customer protection must move together, so that no group is left behind. Indian entities have also long used rupee-denominated debt sold in overseas markets to attract foreign investment and reduce their dependence on domestic borrowing. Parliament has taken up changes to insurance law that would let foreign investors hold a larger stake in insurance companies and strengthen the regulator's enforcement powers. On the revenue side, the government raises money through taxes, cesses and surcharges, and each is governed differently. A cess is levied for a specific purpose and used only for that purpose, while a surcharge adds to the Union's revenue without any specific earmarking. A new cess bill has also been proposed for goods that carry high health costs. Together, these measures show how the state balances revenue needs, public welfare and investor confidence in a changing economy. Economists and policy analysts often compare how different revenue tools share money between the Union and the states, because the choice of tool determines who benefits. Such comparisons help students understand why the same economy can be funded through very different instruments for very different purposes.

Q1.

Masala bonds are governed by which central bank?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the International Finance Corporation introduce masala bonds?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana, over how many crore bank accounts were opened? (in crore)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Bill 2025, what is the new FDI limit in Indian insurance companies? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many key pillars does the National Strategy for Financial Inclusion 2025-30 define?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the pool through which taxes are shared with states?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which product is given as an initial example of goods covered by the Health Security and National Security Cess Bill 2025?

Answer: _____

Repo Cut, D-SIBs and Economic Census

Economic news in December 2025 focused on how stable the Indian economy looked and how the banking system is being watched more closely. The Reserve Bank of India, which decides monetary policy, recently reduced its key policy rate by a quarter of a percentage point. The central bank described the situation as a rare Goldilocks phase, a term that describes an economy in a balanced state. In such a phase, growth is steady, inflation is low, employment is high and the economy shows no sign of overheating or recession. Regulators have also taken steps to strengthen the largest banks. Some banks are so large and so closely connected with the rest of the system that their failure could disrupt the entire economy, so they must hold extra capital. For customers, the RBI's grievance system has been reorganised. A single integrated scheme now handles complaints against banks, non-banking finance companies and other regulated entities, with the aim of resolving disputes quickly, transparently and at low cost. Looking ahead, the government will conduct another Economic Census once the population census is complete, with the data expected to support a unified business register and better planning for enterprises across the country. Together, these measures show how monetary policy, banking regulation, consumer protection and statistics work as connected parts of the financial system.

Q1.

What is the RBI's repo rate after its December 2025 cut? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Up to how many lakh rupees can an Ombudsman direct a regulated entity to pay as compensation for financial loss? (in lakh)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the informal term used for Domestic Systemically Important Banks?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which authority designates the D-SIBs?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many earlier ombudsman schemes does the Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2021 merge? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year will India conduct its next Economic Census?

Answer: _____

Ecological Services of the Range: TITA

The Aravalli range is a long chain of hills in north-western India, and its ecological role is wider than its physical size suggests. The hills influence the way wind and moisture move over the land around them, which has consequences for rain and temperature across the northern plains. During the monsoon season, the range is part of the system that guides moving air masses. In winter, colder air that approaches from distant regions meets the hills, and the range helps to moderate the effect on the plains. Its surfaces and rocks also matter for water, because rain falling on the range can seep into the ground and reach stores that support dry districts. Forests on the slopes are relevant to the National Capital Region, where the air is affected by vegetation. Many animals and plants also depend on the hills for shelter. The range sits within a landscape of wildlife sanctuaries and bird parks, and it is linked to several major rivers. Its services are spread across climate, water, air and living things, and they reach far beyond the slopes themselves. The range stretches across Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana and Delhi, which means its services are felt across several states. The hills also host a variety of birds and other animals, reflecting their biological richness.

Q1.

The Aravalli range is said to slow the eastward spread of which desert? (name the desert)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Approximately how many plant species does the range provide habitat for? (give the number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

From which region do the cold, dry winter winds that reach the northern plains originate? (name the region)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which gas do the forested stretches of the range absorb over Delhi-NCR? (name the gas)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The range deflects moisture-laden monsoon winds eastward toward which plains? (name the plains)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which particulate matter size do the forested stretches trap in Delhi-NCR, improving air quality? (name it)

Answer: _____

Bill Background Recall

The Viksit Bharat G RAM G Bill 2025 was brought forward to replace MGNREGA, the rural employment law that has shaped rural work for many years. The government has circulated the bill to members of Parliament. It describes the bill as a framework for rural development aligned with a national vision, and says the bill aims to boost rural employment, promote durable asset creation and align development with infrastructure-led growth.

The government's case for change rests on the argument that the older framework is now outdated. It points to major transformations in the rural economy, in livelihoods and in employment patterns since the earlier law was enacted. These shifts, the government says, make the older design a poor fit for present conditions. Critics have also questioned the quality of the assets created under the scheme.

The bill also changes how the programme is funded. Under the earlier model, funding was open-ended and mostly drawn from one level of government. The new framework uses a shared arrangement, and normative allocations are expected to improve fiscal management and targeted spending.

Labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons form part of the rural context behind the change. The bill also adds a digital layer to oversight, with a planned digital ecosystem meant to reduce leakages, improve transparency and track work effectively.

Q1.

The bill is framed under the national vision of Viksit Bharat by which year? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which House of Parliament was the bill introduced? (name of the House)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Critics questioned the quality of the assets created under MGNREGA and called them low-utility or what other kind? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which group reports labour shortages during sowing and harvest seasons? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under the new framework, which body prepares the Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under MGNREGA, funding was open-ended and mostly drawn from which level of government? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which technology does the bill's digital ecosystem mandate for authentication? (one word)

Answer: _____

NALSA and legal aid structure

Legal aid in India is delivered through a network of institutions rather than a single office. At the top of this network sits the National Legal Services Authority, which guides a chain of bodies that reach down to the districts and to the courts. The network exists so that people who cannot easily afford a lawyer are not shut out of the justice system, and its services are meant to be offered on the basis of equal opportunity. The institutions are also expected to spread awareness about legal rights, so that people know when and how to seek help. They organise Lok Adalats and promote the settlement of disputes outside a formal trial. The national body is further expected to monitor how legal aid programmes are working and to develop the rules that govern them. The law that created this network also set out principles on which legal services are to be provided, and these principles guide every level of the structure. Before the present structure was built, the government had already recognised the need to supervise legal aid schemes at the national level, and a dedicated committee was created for that purpose. Each level of the network has its own authority or committee, and together they are meant to make legal help available to people from every background, whatever their income or social position.

Q1.

In which year was NALSA founded? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Article of the Constitution provides for free legal aid to poor and weaker sections? (article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Legal Services Authorities Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who is the ex officio chairman of a District Legal Services Authority? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which committee set up at the national level in 1980 is known by this acronym? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which date did the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 come into force? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Polygamy rates and terms

Polygamy is the subject of a new law in Assam, where the state assembly has passed the Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025 to introduce strict penalties against such practices. The topic sits within the wider field of marriage and family law in India, where personal laws for different communities treat marriage in different ways. The prevalence of polygamy is measured through a national health survey, which reports figures for the country as a whole, for individual states and for religious communities. Assam's figure is set against the national average, and the state's religious communities are reported separately. The survey covers currently married women in a

particular age band and records whether their husband has other wives besides themselves. Such figures allow comparison between states and between religious groups across the country. The Bill is framed as an effort to eliminate polygamous practices, and its provisions extend to residents of Assam as well as to certain people who engage in polygamous marriages outside the state. Its scope therefore reaches beyond marriages performed inside the state. The statistics form the background to the legislative debate in the state, and they are cited alongside the provisions of the Bill. Readers who follow the topic will also see how the law interacts with the marriage statutes that operate across the country.

Q1.

What is the NFHS-5 (2019-21) polygamy rate for India as a whole, in per cent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the NFHS-5 polygamy rate for Assam, in per cent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the NFHS-5 polygamy rate for Muslims in Assam, in per cent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term describes a marital system in which one man has several wives? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the NFHS-5 national polygamy rate for Sikhs, in per cent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the NFHS-5 national polygamy rate for Christians, in per cent? (number only)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which national survey, covering 2019-21, reports these polygamy rates? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Personal laws: years and terms

Marriage in India is governed by personal laws that differ according to religion, so the legal position on a second marriage is not the same for every community. Statutes differ on whether a second marriage during the subsistence of the first is treated as wrongful, while other personal laws leave room for more than one spouse. The legal framework is part of the background to the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Bill 2025, which the state assembly has passed. Criminal law also addresses marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse, under a code enacted in 2023. The Bill applies to residents of Assam and also covers individuals engaged in polygamous marriages outside the state, which gives it a reach beyond the state's own population. The Uniform Civil Code is the idea of a common set of personal laws that would apply to all citizens irrespective of religious affiliations. Several judgments of the Supreme Court have discussed the need for reform of personal laws over the decades. The Law Commission has also examined the subject in its consultation report. The Bill's objective is to eliminate polygamous practices across India, not only in Assam. The debate on uniformity has continued for many decades. Each of these points forms part of the wider context in which the state's Bill is discussed.

Q1.

In which year was the Hindu Marriage Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What term describes marrying again while a first marriage subsists, which the Hindu Marriage Act prohibits for Hindus? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the 1937 Act, polygamy is permitted for which community's personal law? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What term describes the constitutional rights against which Shariat marriages can be tested? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many years separate the enactment of the Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act (1937) and the Hindu Marriage Act (1955)? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Terms for a Falling Currency

When a currency's value falls, financial news commonly uses two terms: depreciation and devaluation. Both describe a lower value for the currency against foreign currencies, yet the terms are not identical, and the distinction matters when a currency's movement is discussed. In recent months, the rupee's decline against the US dollar has been described mainly in terms of depreciation. Analysts have pointed to the sustained strength of the dollar as one of the wider developments in the background, alongside uncertainty about trade ties between India and the United States. Understanding the two terms helps readers follow economic debates. A fall in a currency's value can be discussed in different ways, depending on what is being described. The rupee's movement in 2025 was reported in the December 2025 current affairs coverage of the economy, and the booklet explains the vocabulary used in that coverage. Readers of current affairs should therefore look at the context in which a currency's value changes before deciding which term applies. The terms appear often in news coverage of the rupee, which makes them useful to recognise when reading about the economy. The rupee's decline is one example of how these terms are used in practice. Both terms are used in the booklet's economy section, which explains each one in turn.

Q1.

Under which type of exchange rate system does devaluation occur? (one or two words)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Along with the government, which central bank is named as deliberately reducing a currency's value in devaluation? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which abbreviation, standing for a current account measure, is named as a cause of depreciation? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which type of system does depreciation occur? (one or two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Devaluation is used as a policy tool to boost what kind of activity? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along with boosting exports, what does devaluation as a policy tool aim to reduce? (one word)

Answer: _____

Who Gains and Who Pays

A currency's fall against foreign currencies has effects that run in more than one direction through an economy. Some effects are favourable, while others add costs to households, businesses and the government. The booklet presents these consequences under two headings, positive and negative, which helps readers weigh gains against burdens. Trade, government budgets and companies are all touched by such changes, and the effects can be felt in different ways by different groups. In 2025 the rupee's weakness drew close attention in financial markets, even though India's economy showed strong growth at the time. The booklet also discusses measures aimed at stabilising the rupee. The booklet's account therefore covers both sides of the picture, so readers can see how each consequence is grouped under its heading and how the two headings relate to one another in the economy section. Under the positive heading, the booklet lists effects that make some parts of the economy more competitive. Under the negative heading, it lists effects that raise costs for households, businesses and the government. The booklet also explains the reasons behind several of these effects, so each one can be understood in context rather than in isolation. The rupee's path in 2025 is one example of how such effects appear in practice, since its weakness was discussed alongside India's growth.

Q1.

Which group of people gets a more favourable exchange rate when sending money home? (short form)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the name the booklet gives to the rise in prices caused by costlier imports? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which subsidy-linked import becomes costlier, leading to a larger subsidy bill? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the risk called when a weak rupee reduces investor confidence? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which sector does a weak rupee encourage, as expensive imports push local production? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Companies with which type of loans face higher repayment costs when the rupee weakens? (one word)

Answer: _____

Repo Rate and Other Tools

The central bank steers the economy through the interest rates it sets, and the repo rate is one of its main tools in this context. When inflation is high, raising the rate makes borrowing expensive, which discourages spending and slows the flow of money in the economy. Monetary policy is formed and managed by the central bank to control a nation's overall money supply and to achieve economic growth. It differs from fiscal policy, which is managed by the Ministry of Finance and measures spending and taxation. The Reserve Bank of India releases a Monetary Policy Report once every six months, explaining the sources of inflation and forecasting it for six to eighteen months ahead. Inflation targeting is a monetary policy framework in which the central bank aims to keep the rate of inflation within a targeted range that is defined in advance. Apart from the repo rate, the central bank has several other instruments, and each of them acts on a different part of the banking system. The central bank uses these tools together to balance liquidity, price stability and growth, which are the goals of monetary policy. The Reserve Bank of India is the central bank responsible for managing the country's financial system, and its policy tools are read together with the rate decisions it announces.

Q1.

What is the abbreviation for the ratio of deposits that banks must hold as cash with the RBI? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which long-term rate, unlike the short-term repo rate, is charged by the central bank when it lends to other banks? (name the rate)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What does the abbreviation MSF stand for? (name the facility)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the abbreviation for the statutory minimum share of deposits that banks hold as liquid cash, gold or other securities? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What does the 'Repo' in 'repo rate' stand for? (name the two-word term)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which tool involves the buying or selling of government securities to inject or absorb liquidity? (name the tool)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the rate at which RBI borrows money from commercial banks called? (name the rate)

Answer: _____

Price Indices and Their Coverage

Price movements in an economy are followed through statistical indices rather than through a single figure. An index tracks a set of goods and services over time and compares their prices with those in a chosen base period. Each item in the set is given a weight, usually expressed as a percentage, which shows how much that item contributes to the final number. Because the set of items and the weights differ from one index to another, the same economy can present different figures depending on the index used. One index breaks household spending into groups such as food, fuel and light, clothing and footwear, housing, and miscellaneous items, each with its own percentage weight. The publishing body and the method note therefore matter as much as the headline value. A reader who wishes to compare two numbers should first check which goods and services each index includes, whether the index covers services, and which period is treated as the reference. Changes measured from the base period are read as movements in the index, and a rise or fall in the value shows how the set of items has moved. Careful readers therefore look at coverage, weights and reference period together before deciding what a change in an index means.

Q1.

What is the base year of the Consumer Price Index? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which agency releases the Consumer Price Index? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which ministry does the Office of Economic Advisor, which releases the WPI, function? (name the ministry)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which index covers only goods and does not consider the services sector? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the measure that compares annual production value at current prices with a base year? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which index has separate versions for agricultural labourers, rural labourers and industrial workers? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the term for an increase in the overall prices of goods and services in an economy over time? (one word)

Answer: _____

Origins and Functions of the RBI

The Reserve Bank of India sits at the centre of the country's financial system. The institution was not always under public control, since it began with private stakeholders before the state took over.

It was set up under a law passed by the British government and began operating in an eastern city, on a fixed day of the year. Its tasks are varied. It grants bank licences, approves the opening of branches and inspects banks. In the foreign exchange area it holds the country's reserves, manages its dealings and enforces exchange rules. It also manages the financial affairs of the central government and provides advances to state governments through agreements. The Bank acts as a banker to other banks and to the government. Monetary policy, which the Bank manages, differs from fiscal policy handled by the Ministry of Finance. The Bank also publishes a Monetary Policy Report and intervenes to limit volatility in the rupee against the dollar. Its functions are set out in the RBI Act of 1934, and that Act sets the framework within which the Bank works with the government, the banking sector and the public. The Bank's tasks are discharged across its offices and departments in the country. Together these roles make the Bank a central point of the country's money and banking system.

Q1.

Which commission recommended the establishment of the RBI? (name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the RBI established? (name the city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

On which day and month was the RBI established? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Dr. Ambedkar's book, whose ideas inspired the RBI's concept, has what title? (name the title)

Answer: _____

Q5.

The RBI acts as custodian of the cash reserves of which institutions? (name, two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of the RBI's role of formulating policy to keep prices steady while promoting growth? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the function under which the RBI exchanges and destroys currency notes? (two words)

Answer: _____

Corridors and Connectivity with Russia

India and Russia treat transport links as a practical part of their wider partnership. The 23rd Annual Summit, held in New Delhi, discussed several corridors that could make the movement of goods between the two countries easier. The most prominent proposal is the Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor, a sea route linking the Indian port of Chennai with the Russian port of Vladivostok. Its stated purpose is to carry cargo and reduce the time needed to reach Russia compared with the existing route between the two ports.

A second channel is the International North-South Transport Corridor, a transport network that includes India, Russia and other member states. Both corridors appear in the summit's connectivity agenda, which also covers Russia's Far East and the Arctic.

Cooperation in the Far East and the Arctic is guided by a separate programme, which lists several sectors for joint work. These sectors include mining, pharmaceuticals and manpower. The summit also addressed trade more generally, with a comprehensive programme meant to diversify ties beyond defence and energy.

The partnership itself has a long history. India and Russia have a treaty of peace and friendship, and in 2010 their relationship was upgraded to a Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership. Transport planning sits alongside these political agreements, and the summit documents list connectivity among its major outcomes.

Q1.

In which year was the International North-South Transport Corridor established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

By how many days can the proposed Chennai-Vladivostok Maritime Corridor save transport time? (days, up to)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city was the INSTC established? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which period does the India-Russia Far East Cooperation Programme cover? (years)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many countries established the International North-South Transport Corridor? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country, apart from India and Russia, is a founder of the INSTC? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Arctic forum has India as an Observer? (two words)

Answer: _____

Diplomacy, Honours and Dialogue

India and Russia have a long diplomatic history, and the 23rd Annual Summit in New Delhi showed how both governments view the partnership. The meeting marked 25 years of strategic partnership, and its outcomes covered economic, defence, energy and migration topics. The summit also marked Russia's President's first visit to India in four years.

Security was another focus of the discussions. Both sides condemned attacks that had taken place in their countries. The two governments also discussed their cooperation in international forums such as the UN, G20, BRICS and SCO.

Honours also featured in the summit's record. Russia's highest national award was conferred on Prime Minister Narendra Modi for his contribution to fostering India-Russia ties. The award was presented during the visit, and it recognised the work done to strengthen bilateral relations.

Dialogue between the two countries also takes other forms. A platform for enhancing the Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership, which was upgraded in 2010, involves government bodies and research institutions. The summit documents describe cooperation in areas such as nuclear energy and defence, and they mention regular defence exercises as well. The defence agenda also includes joint research and development, co-production under Make in India, and military technology transfer.

Q1.

In which year was the Treaty of Peace and Friendship between India and Russia signed? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which Tsar established the Order of St Andrew the Apostle? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was the Order of St Andrew the Apostle abolished? (year)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Ganga-Volga Dialogue conceptualised? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which bird features in the emblem of the Order of St Andrew the Apostle? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which apostle is the Order of St Andrew the Apostle named after? (name)

Answer: _____

Assam ST Proposal and Labour Rights

The Assam Group of Ministers has recommended Scheduled Tribe status for a group of communities, a move that would be a significant step toward inclusion for them. Scheduled Tribe status is granted to groups identified under the Constitution, and the President holds the authority to notify the initial list. Any later revision of that list needs approval from Parliament. The proposal would create a new category called ST (Valley), and all such communities would fall under a National ST List. Until formal approval, the ministers have suggested a temporary relief in the form of sub-categorising the existing OBC quota within the state.

The move is described as a major inclusion step, but it has not yet been formally approved. At present, Assam has two ST segments. ST (Plains) carries a reservation of ten per cent, while ST (Hills) carries a smaller share. The proposal is therefore significant for reservation policy in the state.

The debate on workplace rights has its own constitutional roots. A proposed Right to Disconnect is linked to the right to dignity and a life with meaningful rest. The Constitution also directs the State to protect workers' health and to create humane and safe working conditions. Such a law would give employees a statutory right to refuse work messages beyond work hours and on holidays.

Q1.

What reservation share, in per cent, does the ST (Hills) segment have in Assam?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which article is Scheduled Tribe defined as a group identified under Article 342?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many communities did Assam's Group of Ministers recommend for ST status? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which article is the right to dignity and a life with meaningful rest placed, as cited for the Right to Disconnect?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which article does the Constitution direct the State to prevent exploitation of workers' health?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which country did a 2024 amendment to the Fair Work Act let employees decline after-hours work communications?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which article does the President get the authority to notify the initial list of Scheduled Tribes?

Answer: _____

Big Cats, CITES and UNEA-7

The International Big Cat Alliance is a multi-country coalition that aims to conserve the world's large wild cats. It was set up to mark a major anniversary of India's tiger conservation programme. Its implementing body is a national authority under the environment ministry, and its secretariat is based in New Delhi. Countries where big cats live are invited to join, and any member of the United Nations is eligible. The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species is a legally binding agreement that regulates global trade in wild fauna and flora. The agreement does not replace national laws, so countries must pass domestic legislation to enforce it. Its appendices divide species according to the level of trade control they need. Wildfire management also features in global talks. The United Nations Environment Assembly held its seventh session in Kenya in 2025, with the theme of a resilient planet. At that session, India's resolution on wildfire management was adopted. It calls for early warning systems, community-focused alert mechanisms and joint frameworks for prevention and recovery. It also supports national and regional action plans for integrated fire management, and it encourages the sharing of best practices among countries.

Q1.

In which year was the International Big Cat Alliance launched?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which national body implements the International Big Cat Alliance?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did CITES come into force?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was CITES signed?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which CITES appendix lists species threatened with extinction, where commercial trade is prohibited? (Roman numeral)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which city was UNEA-7 held in 2025?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The International Big Cat Alliance was set up to celebrate how many years of Project Tiger? (in years)

Answer: _____

Leaders, Goa and NACP V

Good Governance Day is marked on 25 December, the birth anniversary of Atal Bihari Vajpayee. He served as Prime Minister for three terms and became the first non-Congress Prime Minister to complete a full term. During his government, India conducted nuclear tests, and a major highway project was launched to connect important cities. He was honoured with the Padma Vibhushan and later with the Bharat Ratna.

The same day honours Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya, who was a Congress president on several occasions. He founded a university in Varanasi and a Hindi weekly named Abhyudaya. He was also associated with the Hindu Mahasabha, which he helped establish.

Goa's history is marked by a long period of Portuguese rule. After Indian armed forces acted in 1961, Goa, Daman and Diu became a union territory. Portugal later formally recognised Indian sovereignty over these territories through a treaty. Goa eventually attained full statehood, and it has since been one of India's states.

The National AIDS Control Programme is in its fifth phase, which is a central sector scheme. The phase aligns with a Sustainable Development Goal that targets ending AIDS as a public health threat. Between 2010 and 2024, national HIV prevalence declined, and new infections fell by nearly half. The programme is implemented by the National AIDS Control Organisation under the health ministry.

Q1.

In which year was Atal Bihari Vajpayee posthumously awarded the Bharat Ratna?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did India conduct the Pokhran-II nuclear tests under Vajpayee's government?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year was Banaras Hindu University founded by Madan Mohan Malaviya?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did Goa attain full statehood?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did Portugal formally recognise Indian sovereignty over Goa, Daman and Diu?

Answer: _____

Q6.

By which year does NACP V aim to end AIDS as a public health threat? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many times was Madan Mohan Malaviya President of the Indian National Congress? (number)

Answer: _____

Wetlands, Satellites and Heritage Facts

India has added two wetlands, Siliserh Lake and Kopra Reservoir, to the Ramsar List of wetlands of international importance. Siliserh Lake is located in Alwar, Rajasthan, while Kopra Reservoir is in Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh. The additions raise the total number of such wetlands in India.

A commercial communications satellite, BlueBird Block-2, was launched by ISRO for AST SpaceMobile, a company based in the United States. The satellite was launched on a commercial mission. The satellite is described as the largest commercial communications satellite deployed in Low Earth Orbit. Low Earth Orbit is preferred for Earth observation, communication constellations and hosting platforms such as the International Space Station.

In defence news, DRDO successfully tested the K-4 submarine-launched ballistic missile from INS Arighat. It also completed trials of the Akash-NG surface-to-air missile, produced with Bharat Electronics Limited.

Assam's Majuli hosts the Charaichung Festival, which promotes awareness of a protected royal bird sanctuary described as Asia's first. Majuli is recognised as the world's largest river island.

India marks International Cheetah Day on December 4. Project Cheetah, launched in 2022, marks the world's first inter-continental translocation of a large wild carnivore to reintroduce cheetahs in India. The International Cheetah Day was established by Dr. Laurie Marker to honour Khayam, the cheetah she raised.

Q1.

In which year was the Charaichung Royal Bird Sanctuary established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Siliserh Lake lies within the buffer zone of which tiger reserve? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Kopra Reservoir is situated in the upper catchment of which river basin? (name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

From which space centre did BlueBird Block-2 lift off? (name of the centre)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the mass of BlueBird Block-2? (in kg)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which commercial interface of ISRO facilitated the BlueBird Block-2 launch? (name or acronym)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Majuli, the world's largest river island, lies on which river? (name of river)

Answer: _____

Institutions, Treaties and Global Bodies

Pax Silica is a US-led strategic geo-economic and technology initiative. It focuses on building a secure, resilient and innovation-driven silicon supply chain, and its scope spans critical minerals, chips, AI infrastructure and logistics. Its key objectives include reducing strategic dependencies on concentrated supply chains.

SoLAR stands for Solar Irrigation for Agricultural Resilience and aims to expand climate-resilient, solar-powered irrigation across South Asia and East Africa. Its first phase focused on pilot interventions and on demonstrating solar irrigation models in South Asia. The initiative seeks equitable and sustainable access for small and marginal farmers.

The Biological Weapons Convention marked its 50th anniversary, and India called for stronger global biosecurity and compliance. The convention prohibits development, production, stockpiling and use of biological and toxin weapons. The convention is administered by the United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs.

UNESCO is a specialised UN agency dedicated to fostering shared humanity through education, science, culture and communication.

The Asian Development Bank promotes sustainable, inclusive and climate-resilient economic development in Asia and the Pacific. In a recent update, it revised India's FY26 GDP growth forecast upward, from an earlier projection of 6.5 per cent.

The Kimberley Process is a tripartite global mechanism involving national governments, the international diamond industry and civil society organisations. The Kimberley Process aims to ensure that the global diamond trade does not fuel armed conflict or instability.

Q1.

In which city is the International Water Management Institute, which implemented SoLAR Phase I, located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city is the UN Office for Disarmament Affairs, which administers the Biological Weapons Convention, located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is UNESCO headquartered? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Who is the Director-General of UNESCO? (name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did the Biological Weapons Convention enter into force? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What percentage shareholding does Japan hold in the Asian Development Bank? (in per cent)

Answer: _____